Gastrometrics

USER MANUAL

Cost, sell and grow with Gastrometrics

The complete guide to turning your recipes into fair prices, keeping your inventory under control and understanding the numbers behind your kitchen.

Ingredients · Recipe Sheet · Inventory · Menus · Purchase Orders · Sales · Reports · Team

October 2026 edition

gastrometrics.org

USER MANUAL

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If this is your first time, read chapter 1 and then jump straight to what you need: every chapter stands on its own.

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01

Welcome to Gastrometrics

Gastrometrics turns your recipes into clear numbers: what each dish costs you, what to sell it for and how much it leaves you. This chapter shows you the big picture and the fastest path to your first result.

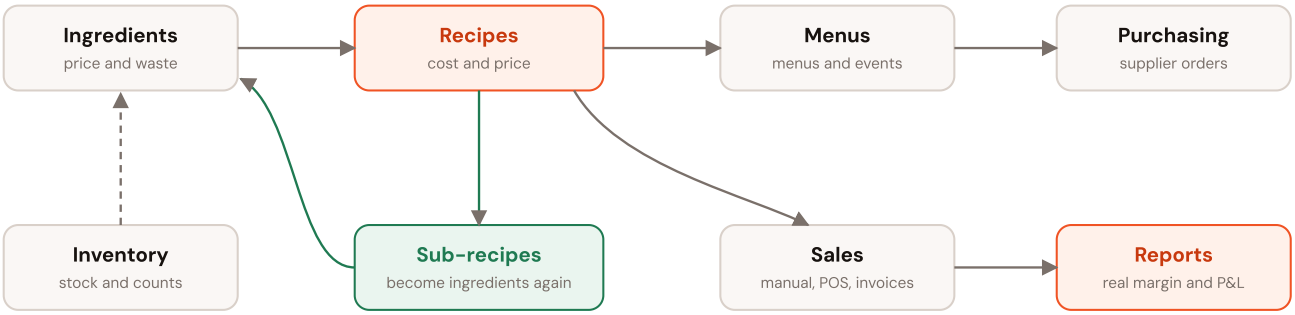
IN THIS CHAPTER

1. What Gastrometrics does for you
2. How the modules connect
3. Your first 10 minutes
4. How to read this manual

What Gastrometrics does for you

You enter your ingredients with what you pay for them, build your recipes with the quantities you use, and the app works out the **real cost of every dish**, suggests a **selling price** and shows your **margin**. From there, everything else —inventory, menus, purchasing, sales and reports— uses those same numbers, so you never have to type them twice.

How the modules connect



Solid arrow = automatic · dashed arrow = you record it (a count or a purchase)

Recipes are at the center: they read your ingredient prices and feed menus, purchase orders and reports. Change an ingredient's price and every recipe that uses it recalculates on its own.

Your first 10 minutes

1. **Add 3 or 4 ingredients** in Ingredients, with their purchase price and net content. You don't need your full inventory to get started.
2. **Create your first recipe** in the Recipe Sheet: pick those ingredients and enter the quantity you use of each.
3. **See the result**: production cost, suggested price and margin appear on the same screen, in real time.
4. **Save and export** the sheet as a PDF for your kitchen or your accountant.
5. **Carry on whenever you like** with inventory, menus or purchasing. They aren't required to see your first price.

Rather see an example first?
If you don't have any recipes yet, the Dashboard offers **"See an example first"**: it creates a sample recipe with its cost and price already calculated so you can see how it works. You can delete it anytime.

How to read this manual

Tip
Shortcuts and good habits that save you time.

Important
Details worth knowing before you press a button.

Plan
Features that depend on your subscription plan (chapter 14).

02

Your account and businesses

Everything in Gastrometrics belongs to a business. Here you'll see how to sign up, create businesses, move between them and make the most of the Dashboard.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. Creating your account
2. Creating a business
3. Switching between businesses
4. The Dashboard
5. The side menu

Creating your account

Sign-up is a 5-step wizard: your details and password, your professional information (country, currency, business type and size), the **plan** you want, acceptance of the terms, and a final summary. If you arrive from the pricing page with a plan already chosen, it comes preselected. Each plan shows what it includes and what it doesn't; **Foodie** (free) is selected by default. If you pick a paid plan, you go to the payment screen when you finish.

The last step has an optional box to **receive updates and reminders by email**. It starts unchecked and you can change it anytime in Settings (chapter 15).

When you sign in, the **Remember me on this device** box is checked: your session stays open. Uncheck it on a shared computer and the session ends when you close the browser.

If you see the **Continue with Google** button, you can also create your account or sign in with your Google account, without a password. The first time, we ask for your country, your currency and that you accept the terms. If you already had an account with that same email, you sign in to the same account.

Didn't get the confirmation email? Check your spam folder and, if it isn't there, tap **Resend the email** on the "Check your email" screen or in the notice that appears when you try to log in without confirming. You can request it once a minute. Until you confirm your email you can't enter the app.

Creating a business

1. **Basics and logo.** Name, description, business type and, if you like, a logo that will appear in the header of your PDFs.
2. **Monthly fixed costs.** Rent, utilities, staff, marketing and others. They're used to spread your fixed costs into the price of each dish (chapter 4).
3. **Default pricing method.** “Food Cost %” (recommended, selected by default) or “Gastrometrics” (6 cost items, advanced). Every new recipe inherits it, and you can change it recipe by recipe.

Restaurant · Coffee shop · Bakery · Pastry shop · Food Truck · Catering · Bar · Pizzeria · Fast Food · Other

Each business has its own ingredients, recipes, inventory, menus and purchasing: nothing mixes between businesses. Inside each business panel you can choose from 12 theme colors, which also color the accents of its PDFs.

> **Bring what's on your main dashboard**
> A new business starts empty. When you create it we offer **Bring from my main space**: choose the recipes (or all of them) and they arrive with their ingredients and sub-recipes, already costed with the business's prices; if you want, also the ingredients no recipe uses. Anything already there with the same name isn't duplicated and your main dashboard doesn't change. The same button is at the top of each business's page, and in My Recipes you can migrate recipe by recipe with “Migrate to another business”.

Switching between businesses

Businesses shows one card per business with an “Open” button. While you work in any module, the side menu also lists your businesses so you can jump between them without going back to the start.

The Dashboard

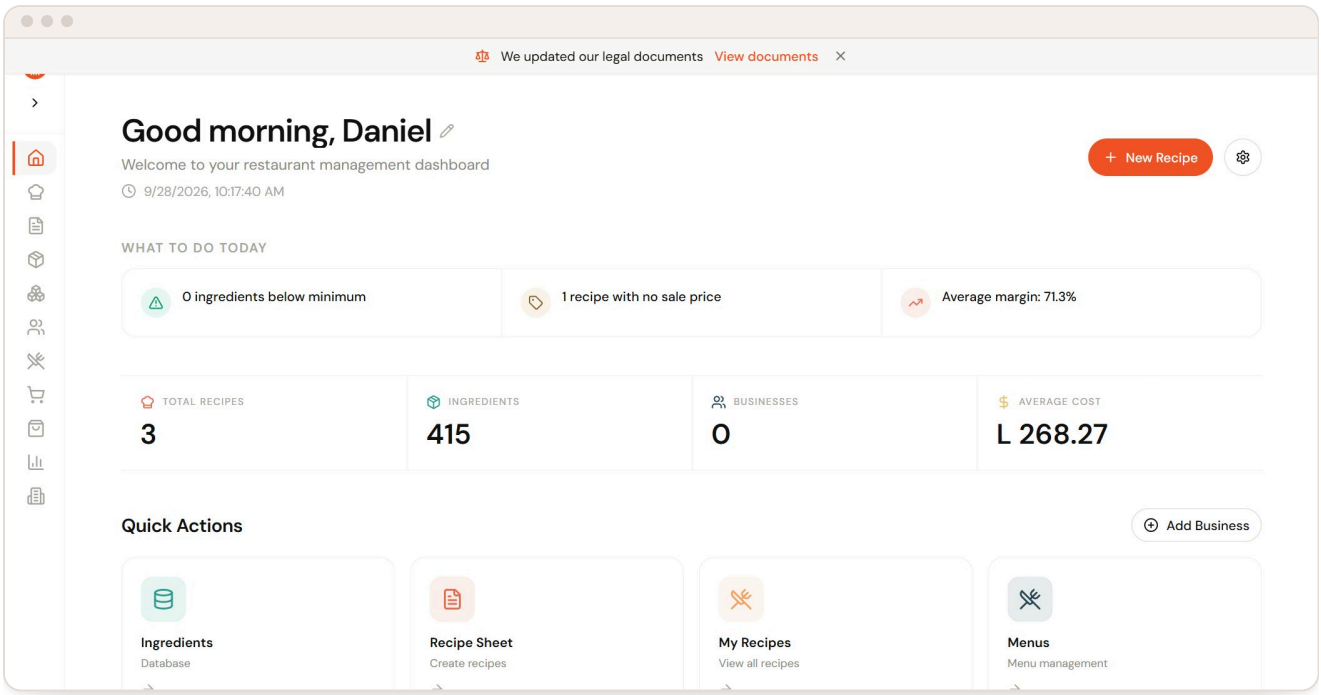


Figure 1 The Dashboard: what needs your attention today, your key figures and shortcuts to every module.

- **What to do today**: ingredients below their minimum, recipes without a selling price and your average margin. Each card takes you straight to where you can fix it.
- **Key figures**: total recipes, ingredients, businesses and average cost, across all your businesses.
- **Quick actions**: one shortcut per module so you can jump in without the side menu.
- **Recent activity**: what you and your team did (recipes, ingredients, imports, invitations).
  Notifications: what happened on its own or needs your attention: a price that went up after a cost change, a margin that went up, your plan changing or expiring, support replies and what's new in the app. Tap one to see the details (before and after, why it happened) and a button to go handle it; a what's-new item reopens its window with "See the tutorial".

While you get started, the Dashboard shows **Your path**: add ingredients, create your first recipe, reach 3 recipes and explore what's new. Each step takes you straight to where it's done. You can hide it with the X.

The Your path buttons open the import directly: "Import my ingredients" and "Import a recipe". If you'd rather start from scratch, each step also has the manual option.

The side menu

SECTION	WHAT IT'S FOR
Dashboard	An overview of your whole account and what needs attention.
Recipe Sheet	Create or edit a recipe, with its cost and price.
My Recipes	Search, duplicate, move and recover recipes.
Ingredients	Your ingredient database, prices and waste.

SECTION	WHAT IT'S FOR
Inventory	Stock, counts and minimum-level alerts.
Team	Invite people and give them permissions.
Menus	Build menus by course for service or events.
Purchase Orders	Supplier orders, by hand or suggested.
Sales	Record sales, import your POS and issue invoices.
POS	Floor, orders by seat, kitchen and checkout.
Reports	Business overview and finances.
Businesses	Create, open and delete businesses.

The menu fills in as you go

So you're not overwhelmed, the menu starts with the essentials. With your first recipe, Reports and Sales appear; with 3 recipes, Inventory, Menus, MEP, Purchase orders, POS and Team. When they open, we announce them in a window and highlight them (in the menu, in Quick actions and in the phone's bottom bar) as "New" until you open them. The welcome tutorial shows you this map from the start. To see everything now, use "Show all modules now" at the bottom of the menu.

Invitation to other modules

If you use GastroMetrics every week and haven't opened a module in your menu for more than 21 days (or never), a short window tells you what it's for, with **Open** and **Not now**. It follows the system's natural order: ingredients and recipe sheets first, then inventory, menus, purchasing, sales, POS, reports and team. It shows at most once a week, and the same module doesn't repeat for 30 days.

Tutorials, tips and what's new

A **guided tutorial** takes you by the hand through the whole app and each stage unlocks as you go: your ingredients (it first asks whether you want to import your whole list at once, which we recommend, or add them one by one, field by field), waste once you have 3 ingredients, your first recipe sheet (importing a written recipe or creating it step by step, with PAX and the costing method before saving), My Recipes and then each module in the order it's used: Reports and Sales with your first recipe; with 3 recipes, Menus, MEP, Inventory, Purchase Orders, POS and Team. It highlights the button or field to use and moves on when you use it; to go to the next module it points out where to tap in the menu; at the bottom you'll see your goal and progress (for example, 2/3 ingredients). The X pauses it. If you already used GastroMetrics, you can skip it entirely; **Restart tutorial** in the menu: from the Dashboard it starts everything again; from a module, it goes over just that module and then you carry on where you were. If you upgrade your plan, the tutorial continues with just what's newly unlocked. Outside the tour (once you finish or skip it) we keep teaching you with one-step **tips**, for example when you open a panel for the first time; if you'd rather not see them, tap **Don't show more tips**. Each step says where the data comes from (**Comes from**) and where it's used (**Used in**), with a numbered **Example**. When we add something new, you'll see the **What's new** window with **See the tutorial**; it also stays in Notifications. The what's-new email has the same link.

In a business, the tutorial only reminds you that it works like your main dashboard, with its things kept separate, and how to bring recipes over: in My Recipes on the main dashboard, tap a recipe and choose “Migrate to another business”. If you were invited to a team, the first time you go through the full tutorial, with the tools you were given.

Tap and its panel opens

Throughout the app, tapping an item —a recipe, an ingredient, an inventory product, a menu, a purchase order, a sales record, an invoice or a business— opens its **panel** on the right: its main details at the top and every action below (the main one first and delete at the end). There are no more three-dot menus. With the keyboard, Enter or Space on the item also opens it.

Nothing gets lost, and dates are day/month/year

If you close or leave without saving a new recipe, a new ingredient, an inventory count, a menu or a purchase order, when you come back you'll see **We recovered what you left unfinished**: 24 hours for recipes and ingredients, 3 days for inventory and orders, 7 days for menus. **Start over** discards it. Every date shows as **day/month/year** (for example 20/10/2026), in any language, including PDFs and emails.

Your feedback

Now and then we'll ask you to rate the app or answer a quick question, for example after your first costed recipe, your first inventory count or your first purchase order. They are one-tap questions about how you work (how often you count stock, how you order from suppliers, which till you use) and they help us decide what to improve. We never ask for amounts or private data. You can always choose **Not now**, and we never ask more than once every 5 days. If you give us permission, your comment may appear on the website with your short name and country.

Questions come up one at a time over the weeks, and the rating is asked only once, with five one-tap faces. Once you've answered the questions, we invite you once to leave a public review on Google or Trustpilot; the invitation is the same for everyone and you can always choose **Not now**.

Settings and My Plan

Settings isn't a page: it's a window you open from any screen with the gear icon. Your plan and subscription live in **My Plan**, at the bottom of the menu.

03

Ingredients

Your ingredients are the foundation of all costing. If their prices are up to date, so are your recipes, menus and reports.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. What an ingredient contains
2. Categories and units
3. Purchase packs
4. Importing your ingredient list
5. Waste
6. Allergens
7. Deleting an ingredient

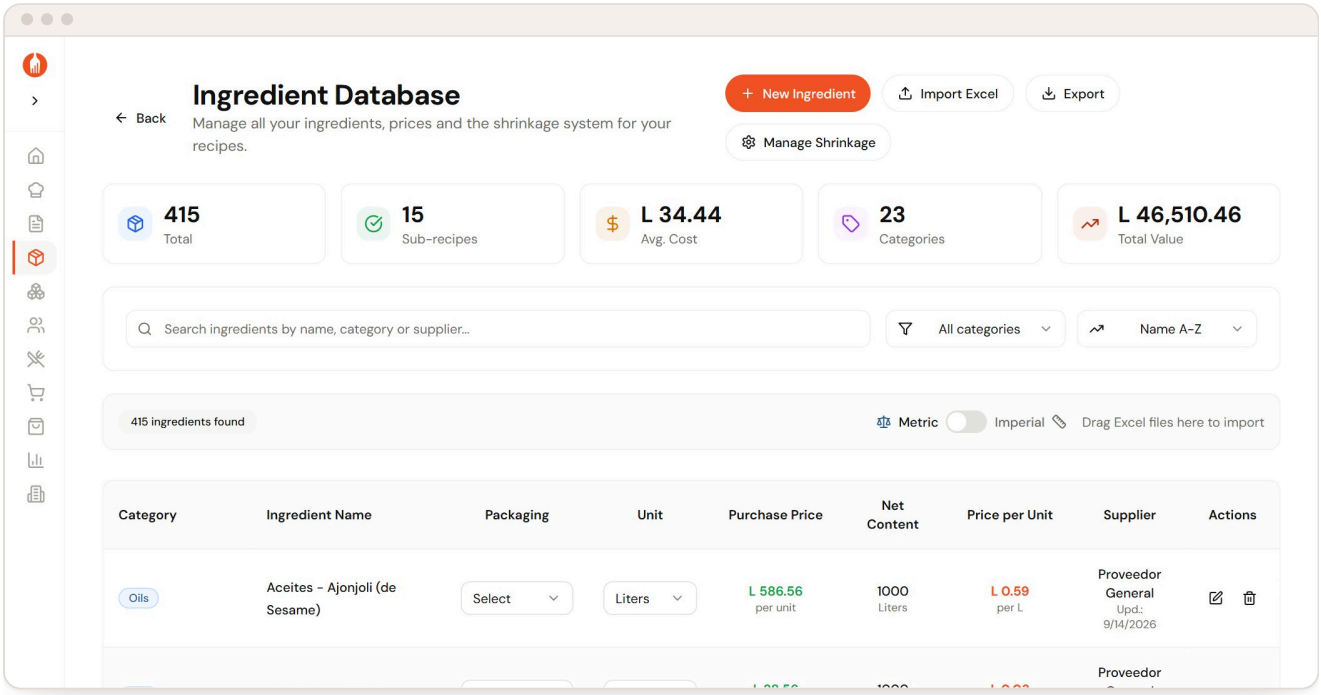


Figure 2 The business's ingredient database, with category, unit, price and supplier.

What an ingredient contains

Name, category, unit of measure, supplier, purchase pack (optional) and its price: what you pay for the whole pack and how much it contains. From that the app calculates the **price per unit**, which is what your recipes actually use.

Under the supplier you see the date the ingredient last changed: when you edited it or an import updated it. Changing the unit, or switching everything to metric or imperial, doesn't change that date.

PRICE PER UNIT

Price per unit = Purchase price ÷ Net content

Net content is in the ingredient's base unit (grams, milliliters, units…).

EXAMPLE · A SACK OF FLOUR

Purchase price of the sack	450.00
Net content	25000 g
Price per gram	**0.018**
A recipe using 300 g costs	300 × 0.018 = 5.40

Categories and units

Categories are a fixed list of 40 (Poultry, Beef, Fish, Dairy, Flour, Spices, Beverages, Spirits, Wine, Beer, Soft drinks & mixers, Disposables…), plus a special one, **Sub-recipe / production**, assigned automatically to preparations you use as an ingredient (chapter 5). The available units are:

Grams · Kilograms · Milliliters · Liters · Ounces · Fluid ounces · Pounds · Gallons · Unit

Use **Unit** for items you count (eggs, cans, bread rolls). The app treats them specially, for example to warn you if a recipe's yield looks too low.

Don't forget packaging
Cups, takeout boxes, bags, napkins or straws are part of each dish's cost too. Add them as ingredients in the **Disposables** category (for example, a pack of 100 boxes, by unit) and put them in the recipe of what you sell to go. Otherwise your price won't cover them.

Purchase packs

If you buy by the Box, Sack, Bottle, Can, Bag or Jar, save how much each pack contains. That way your purchase orders say “4 boxes” instead of a quantity in grams nobody would order.

Importing your ingredient list

Load your whole database at once from Excel, CSV or a pasted list, and export it to Excel whenever you want. If you'd rather start from a format, the app generates a template with its real categories and units; headers are recognized in all 6 languages.

The guided Ingredients tour ends by opening this import, so you can load your whole list at once. If you prefer, you can also add them one by one with "New ingredient".

You don't need the template: upload your file as it is (.xlsx, .xls or .csv) or **paste your list** copied from Excel, Google Sheets, an email or WhatsApp, one per line (for example "Tomato, 2 kg, 3.50"). The app recognizes columns even with other names or no titles, prices with currency symbols and a decimal comma or point ("$8,50", "1,250.75") and content written next to the unit ("25 kg bag"). If the list has no category, one is suggested from the name.

You see everything before importing
The preview shows each ingredient with its content, price and status: "Ready", "No price" or "Already exists" (those are skipped). When it finishes, the app offers the next step: importing your recipes.

Prices and currency

Prices are saved in your account's currency (Settings); the app does not convert between currencies. They're accepted with a symbol or code and with a decimal comma or point: "$8,50" and "8.50" are 8.50, "1.250,75" and "1,250.75" are 1250.75. A number like "1.500" is read as one thousand five hundred if your currency is used without decimals (Costa Rican colón, Colombian, Chilean or Argentine peso, guaraní) or if it carries "₡"; with other currencies it's 1.5. Check the Price column in the preview before importing.

From a receipt or invoice

In the same window, "Photo of the receipt" or "Upload receipt (photo or PDF)" read a supermarket receipt: each product with its price, leaving out totals, taxes, discounts and payments. It takes the size from the name ("550g", "25CL") and weighed products ("0.548 kg"). In the preview you can fix each row's name and price, and "Update the price of those that already exist" updates the price of the ingredient each line matches (converted to its unit) and recalculates their recipes. Names appear as on the receipt, sometimes abbreviated.

Receipt: supplier and which ingredient it is

Above the preview you choose **which supplier the receipt is from** (we try to read it from the header). Next to each line, the “This is…” column says which ingredient it is: the same name from that supplier is picked on its own; if you have several with that name, one from another supplier or one spelled similarly, the line stays on “Choose which one” and nothing changes until you choose. You can also pick “New: create it” or “Skip this line”. What you choose is remembered for that supplier: the next receipt recognizes it on its own. So if you have three “Tomato” from different suppliers, a receipt only updates its own. When you create an ingredient by hand with a name you already have, we let you know; in the Recipe Sheet and purchase orders, those with the same name show their supplier and note.

Complete Excel workbooks

You can upload your costing workbook as it is (.xlsx, .xlsm with macros — the macros are never run — or .xls). If it has several sheets, the app picks the ingredients sheet and you can change it. It recognizes headers even when they aren't in the first row, and columns like "Conversion" and "Recipe unit" (for example, 1 liter = 1000 ml at 586.56 gives the right price per ml). Products without a price can be imported at 0 to complete later, and with "Update the price of those that already exist" your supplier's list updates prices and recalculates your recipes. In My Recipes, the same workbook opens its recipe-sheet tab with name, yield, ingredients with cost and steps.

Plan

Importing lists, Excel files and receipts: every plan. Updating the price of existing ingredients from a receipt or a list: from **Home Cook**.

Waste

Waste is what you pay for but can't use: peels, bones, trimmings, evaporation. In **Manage Waste** you switch the system on and, for each ingredient, choose the typical percentage for its category or your own (or a fixed amount).

REAL COST WITH WASTE

Usable content = Net content × (1 − waste %)

Price per unit = Purchase price ÷ Usable content

You pay for all of it but only use part, so the real price per unit goes up. Turn waste off and everything returns to the original values.

If you already have recipes, when you save we first show which ones change cost and how: the new cost and what happens to the price. When you confirm, their recipe sheets are recalculated automatically, including those that use a sub-recipe with that ingredient. The same happens every time you turn waste on or off or change a percentage. The price follows the usual rule: if the cost rises and leaves it short, it goes up to the suggested price; if the cost drops, it stays and your margin goes up.

Some typical percentages by category: Seafood 63 %, Fish 52 %, Beef 33 %, Poultry 27 %, Fruit 24 %, Vegetables 21 %. Dry and packaged goods start at 0 %. Bar categories have their own typical waste: spirits 2 %, wine 5 %, draft beer 18 % and bottled beer 0 % (chapter 6).

Plan

Waste by category is on every plan, Foodie included. Entering your own percentage or amount per ingredient is from **Home Cook**.

Allergens

In the last step of each ingredient you tick which of the 14 allergens that must be declared it contains (gluten, milk, eggs, tree nuts, soy, fish, crustaceans, sesame…). Recipes that use it —also through their sub-recipes— show them automatically in the Recipe Sheet, in the recipe's three PDFs and under each dish on the customer menu. They're never typed into the recipe by hand, so they don't go out of date.

Deleting an ingredient

Before you confirm, the app shows which recipes use it. It won't stop you, but you'll know which recipes will be left with a missing ingredient.

04

Recipes and the Recipe Sheet

The heart of Gastrometrics: you turn a list of ingredients into an exact cost and a well-founded selling price, always seeing where each number comes from.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. Filling in the sheet
2. Your progress is saved for 24 hours
3. Production cost
4. Two ways to calculate the price
5. Changing the percentages
6. Delivery or card commission
7. Margins and manual prices
8. Scaling with the PAX modifier
9. Import your recipes
10. My Recipes: duplicate, move and trash

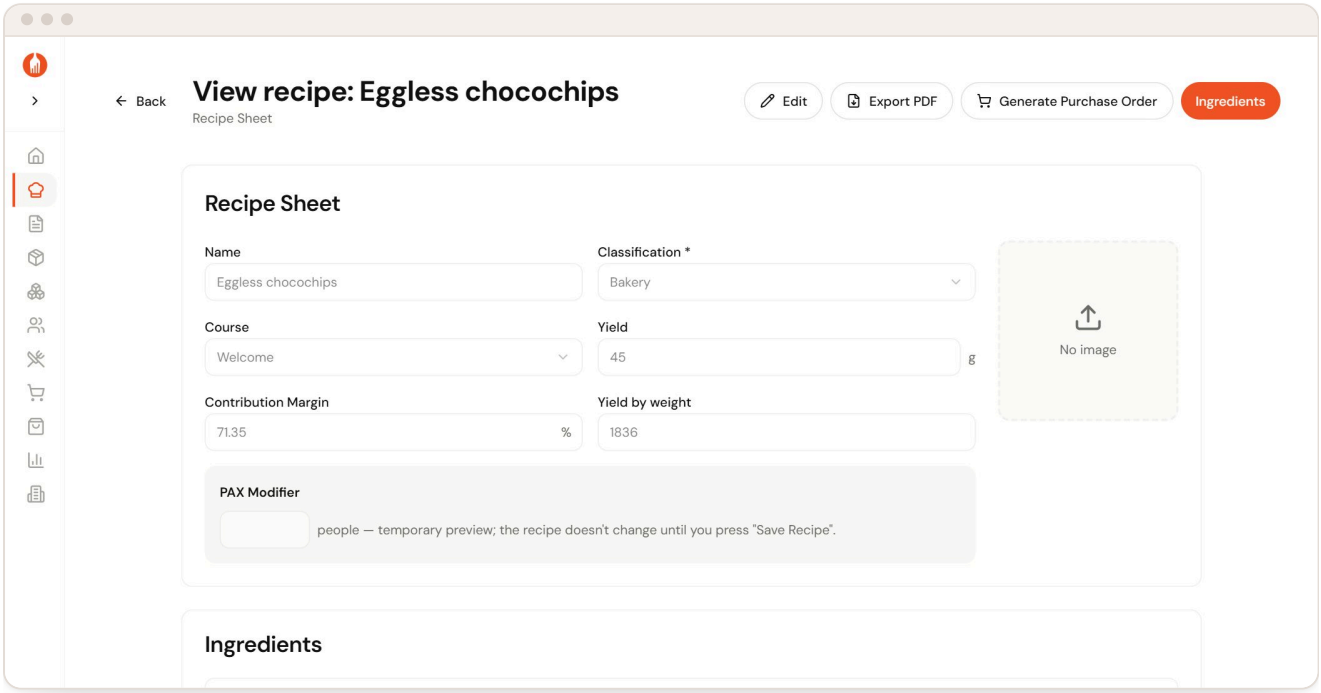


Figure 3 A recipe open in the Recipe Sheet: general details, ingredients and cost calculation.

Filling in the sheet

- **Name** and **Classification** (22 options, from Hot line to Pastry or R&D). The "Sub-recipe" classification turns the recipe into an ingredient (chapter 5). The 5 "Bar · …" classifications calculate the price with pour cost (chapter 6).
- **Course**: where it goes in service (starter, main, dessert…).
- **Yield**: how much the recipe makes (8 portions, 1200 g…) with its unit.
- **Ingredients**: search your database and enter the quantity. Each line shows what it costs.
- **Procedure and notes**, plus a **photo** of the dish.

Move on with Enter

In the first fields, pressing Enter takes you to the next one, so you can fill in the sheet almost without touching the mouse.

Your progress is saved for 24 hours

While you create a new recipe, Gastrometrics keeps an **automatic draft**. If you close the tab, lose your connection or go to another module, coming back to the Recipe Sheet brings the recipe back exactly as you left it, with a notice at the top. The draft lasts **24 hours from your last change** and is also there if you sign in from another device.

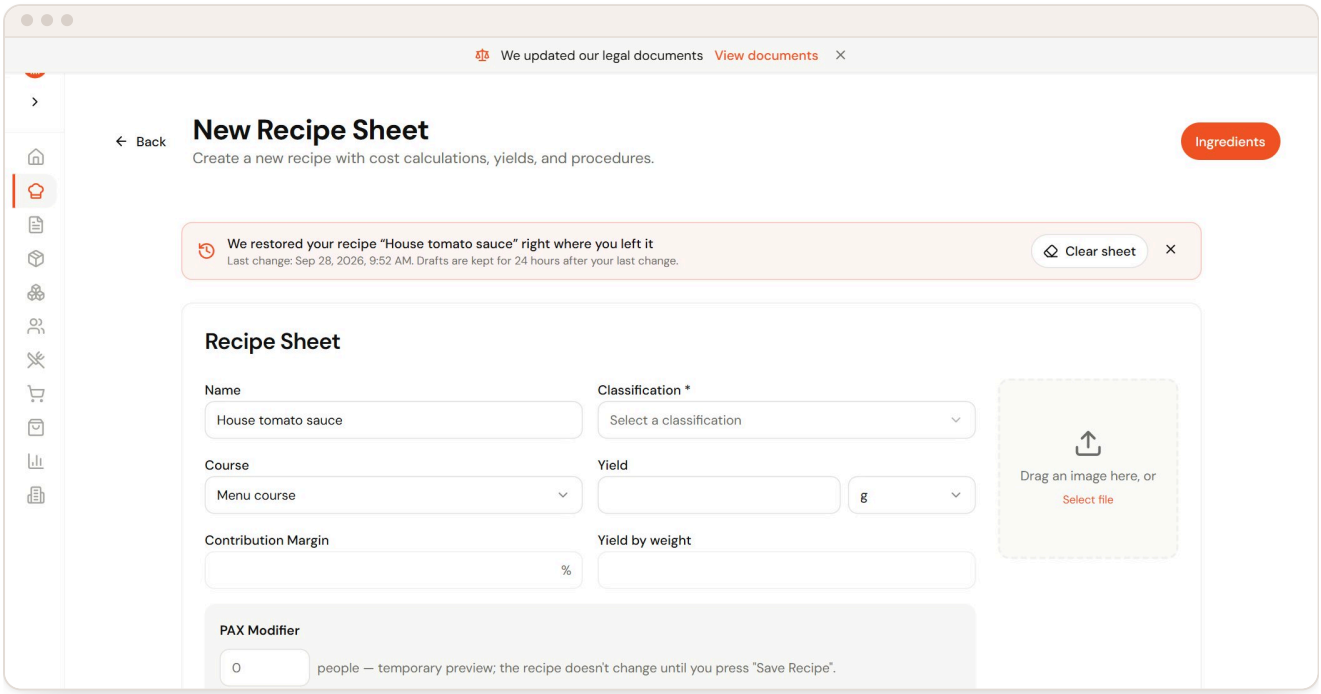


Figure 4 When you come back, a notice confirms your recipe was recovered. "Clear sheet" leaves it blank.

Want to start from scratch? Use **Clear sheet** (next to "Save Recipe" or in the notice). It asks for confirmation and erases everything: name, ingredients, procedure, photo, prices and the saved draft. Saving the recipe deletes the draft automatically.

Production cost

COST OF EACH INGREDIENT AND OF THE RECIPE

Line cost = Quantity × Price per unit

Production cost = Sum of all lines

UNIT COST

Unit cost = Production cost ÷ Yield

If you don't enter a yield, the app estimates it from the total weight of ingredients measured in g, ml, kg or liters.

Two ways to calculate the price

Each recipe uses one of two methods. New recipes start with **Food Cost %**; your business can change that default and you can switch recipe by recipe without losing anything: both start from the same real cost. Recipes you saved earlier with 6 cost items stay as they were.

METHOD 1

Gastrometrics (6 cost items, advanced)

Spreads your profit across six items, each a percentage of production cost: utilities 10 %, marketing 10 %, operating costs 30 %, labor 25 %, tax 0 % and net profit 30 % (all editable).

METHOD 2

Food Cost % (default)

You choose what share of the price the ingredient cost should represent (usually 28 % to 35 %) and the price is worked out from there. It's the industry standard.

SUGGESTED SELLING PRICE

6 cost items: Price = Unit cost + (Sum of items ÷ Yield)

Food Cost: Price = Unit cost ÷ Target % × (1 + Sales tax)

In Food Cost, sales tax (if you use it) is added on top of the price and included in it; with 6 cost items it's one of the items. In both cases the price is rounded **up** to your currency's step: to 5 in lempiras (61 becomes 65, never 60), to 0.50 in dollars or euros (10.60 becomes 11.00), to 100 in colones. It's the only rounding in the calculation. The example below is in lempiras.

In 6 items, every item, including **Markup over cost**, is a percentage of the production cost (a markup), not a margin on sales: 30% on cost doesn't mean keeping 30% of what you sell. You see the real margin on sales in **Contribution Margin**. In 6 items, tax is also added as a percentage of cost; if you want tax on the sale price, use Food Cost %.

EXAMPLE · SAME COST, TWO METHODS (UNIT COST 20, YIELD 1)

6 items: 2 + 2 + 6 + 5 + 0 + 6	21
20 + 21 = 41 → rounded	**45**
Food Cost 30 %: 20 ÷ 0.30 = 66.67 → rounded	**70**

If your business has fixed costs and an estimate of dishes per month, their proportional share is added to the price automatically as one more item:

FIXED COST PER DISH

Fixed cost per dish = Monthly fixed costs ÷ Estimated dishes per month

Changing the percentages

Tap the gear icon in “Sale Price Calculation” to open **Percentage settings**. Each item says what it covers and how much it adds per serving, and below you see the resulting suggested price and food cost % right away; if the cost goes above 40 % of the price or the profit is 0, it warns you. With **Save as default**, your business's new recipes start with those percentages (your tax, for example); saved ones keep their own. **Use the defaults** brings the recipe back to those values. In a Food Cost % recipe, only the tax in this window counts.

Delivery or card commission

If you sell through a delivery app or take card payments, enter in the recipe the **commission %** they keep from the price. The suggested price covers it, and the sheet shows the commission per unit and what you keep after paying it. Profit and margin already deduct it.

PRICE WITH COMMISSION

Price = Price without commission ÷ (1 − Commission %)

In Food Cost with tax: Price = Price without commission ÷ (1 − Commission % × (1 + Tax %))

It works with both methods and is rounded afterwards, as always. With tax, the commission is also charged on the tax, so the price goes up a little more so you keep the same.

The commission is calculated on the price including tax, which is how almost all delivery apps and card terminals charge it. If your provider charges it on the price before tax, the suggested price ends up slightly higher than needed.

EXAMPLE · UNIT COST 20, FOOD COST 30 %, COMMISSION 30 % (IN LEMPIRAS)

Price without commission: 20 ÷ 0.30	66.67
66.67 ÷ (1 − 0.30) = 95.24 → rounded	**100**
The app keeps 30 %	30
You keep per dish	**70**

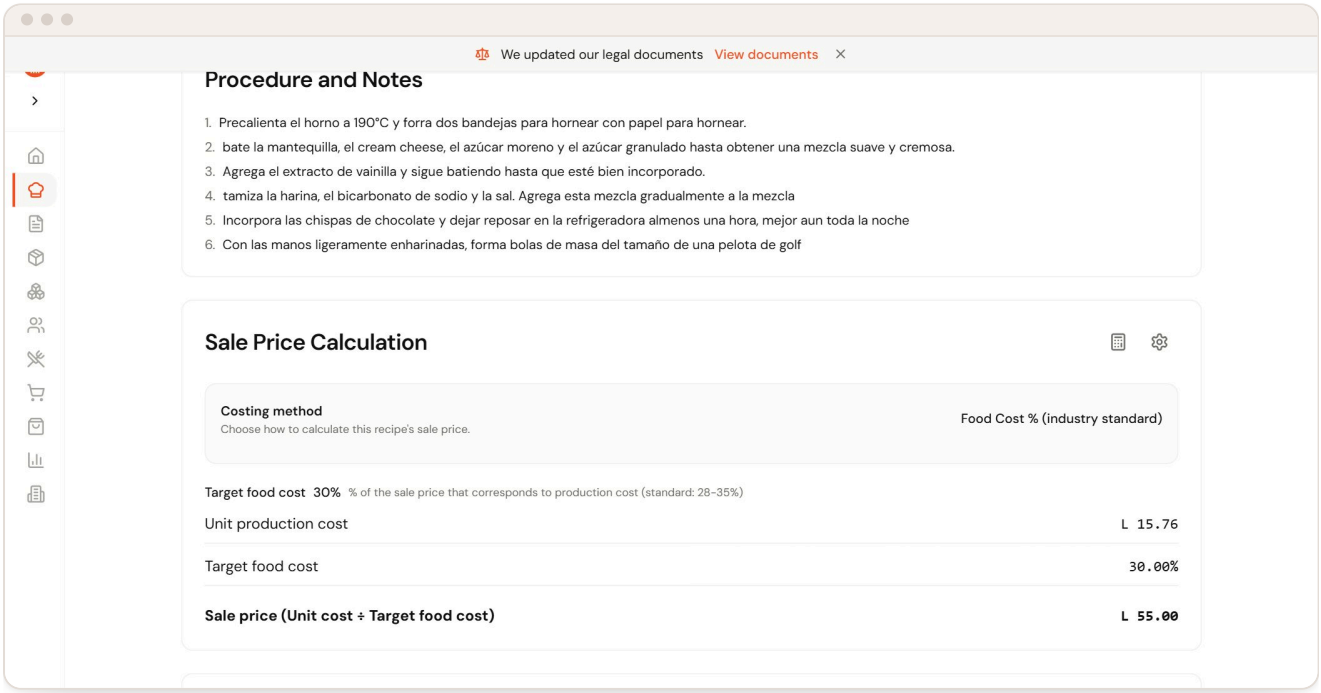


Figure 5 The selling-price calculation with the recipe's chosen method, followed by the cost summary.

Margins and manual prices

RECIPE INDICATORS

Total sales = Final price × Yield
Contribution margin = (Total sales − Production cost) ÷ Total sales
Cost % = Production cost ÷ Total sales

The suggested price is never mandatory: you can type your own **selling price** or your own **unit profit**. Margins recalculate with your number, but cost always reflects what you really pay.

Scaling with the PAX modifier

Enter how many people you want to serve and the app scales every quantity and cost instantly, always rounding **up** so you never fall short. It's a preview: the saved recipe doesn't change. Rounding is to the gram or milliliter in kg and L, and to 0.1 in g, ml, oz and units.

- **Export PDF** or **Generate Purchase Order** with PAX active uses the scaled quantities, without saving anything. The button warns you “Scaled to N”.
- **Saving** with PAX active asks for confirmation: the recipe is stored at the new size and the previous size is kept as the “original”.
- **Restore original recipe** goes back to that original size. Prices are updated to today's. Then press Save to confirm it.

Suspicious yield
If any ingredient measured in “units” is 20 times the declared yield or more (for example, 200 eggs for a yield of 1), you'll see a yellow warning in the sheet and in the PDF. It doesn't block anything: it just helps you catch a typo.

Import your recipes

In My Recipes, **Import recipe** turns a recipe you already have into a recipe sheet: paste it as you have it (from Word, WhatsApp or a website), upload a text file (.txt, .csv, .md), an **Excel** file (.xlsx, .xlsm, .xls) or a **PDF**, or **take a photo** with your phone camera. The app recognizes the name, servings, ingredients with quantity and unit (200 g, 2 cups, ½ kg, "to taste", tables, lists…) and the steps.

One recipe at a time
Each import creates one recipe; after saving, «Import another recipe» moves on to the next. Word files (.docx) can't be uploaded: open the document, copy the text and paste it.

You review it before it opens
Each ingredient is matched with your database and its quantity is converted to that ingredient's unit. Ones you don't have can be created (no price; you complete it later in Ingredients), picked from your list or skipped. Nothing is saved until you press Save in the Recipe Sheet.

Recipe photos

The photo is read on your own phone or computer (it isn't uploaded to any server). You'll see the photo next to the text read, with the reading confidence and doubtful lines highlighted: tap them to fix them before continuing. For best results, shoot straight on, with good light and no shadows, and choose the language the recipe is written in.

Recipe language

You don't have to choose it: the app assumes the recipe is in the language you use in the app and detects on its own if it's in another one (for example, an English or Chinese recipe), then reads it again with the right language. If you want to set it yourself, use "Change" next to the language; if you change it after reading a photo or a scanned PDF, "Read again" appears. PDFs with text are read as they are, without OCR; scanned pages go through the same reading as photos.

What it can and can't do

It reads printed recipes, clear handwriting, screens and PDFs in the app's 6 languages; tables, lists, two-column cards and paragraphs; fractions, ranges ("2-3"), numbers in words, "to taste" and abbreviations like "c", "t" and "T" (cup, teaspoon, tablespoon). On a recipe sheet with costs, the unit cost is used as the suggested price of the new ingredient. In a PDF with many pages (a recipe book) it picks the first page with a recipe and you can change it. A photo taken sideways is rotated automatically. It doesn't read well cursive handwriting, blurry or dark photos, photos taken at an angle (with the page tilted or folded), or pages with several recipes mixed together (import one at a time); it reads the first sheet of an Excel file. It never saves anything without your confirmation: you can always fix the text, each ingredient and its quantity.

How to review what was read

After reading a photo or a scanned PDF you go straight to the recipe as understood, with the photo beside it (tap it to enlarge). At the top you see a summary — how many ingredients were read, how many are already in your database, how many are new and how many should be checked — and each ingredient shows its status: "✓ In your database", "+ New" or "⚠ Check" (the line was read with doubts or the quantity couldn't be converted). If you'd rather fix the text as read, use "Edit the text read".

Plan

Importing recipes in any format (text, Excel, PDF or photo) is included in every plan.

When you save an imported recipe you return to My Recipes with the option "Import another recipe", so you can bring your recipes in one after another: the ingredients you already created are recognized automatically.

My Recipes: duplicate, move and trash

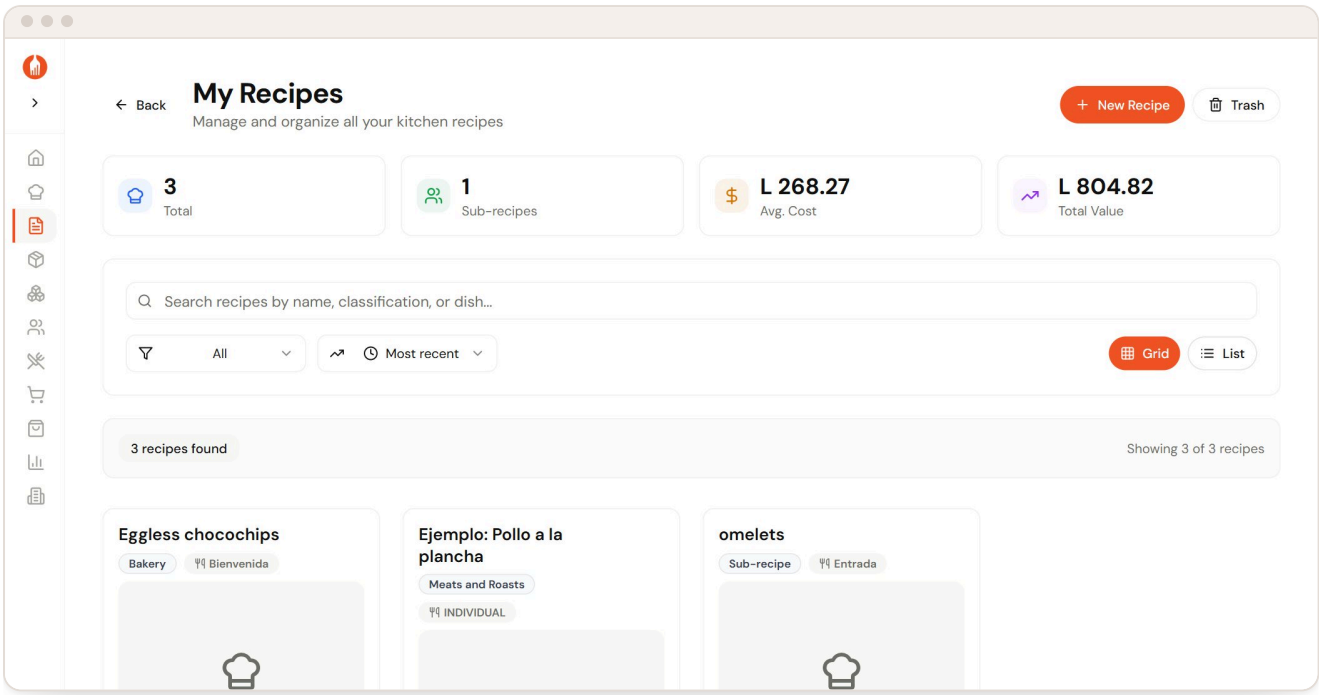


Figure 6 My Recipes: all your recipes with their cost, yield and quick actions.

Search by name, filter by classification and sort by name, cost, date or margin (margin is measured as on the Recipe Sheet; recipes without a price go last). Tap a recipe to open its panel with its cost, price, yield and actions: view, edit, export to PDF, duplicate, migrate and delete. When you save a Recipe Sheet you come back here with the recipe highlighted.

- **Duplicate** creates a copy in the same business, with "(copy)" in the name.
- **Migrate** copies the recipe to another of your businesses. It asks whether to bring its ingredients and sub-recipes too (reusing those that already exist there) or just the recipe: in that case its sheet opens in the business so you pick the ingredients from its own database (those with the same name are linked automatically).
- When you migrate with ingredients, the window lists the ones that business doesn't have: for each one you choose to **copy it** with its price and supplier or to **use one you already have there** (if there's one with the same name, it's already selected). The copy's cost uses the business's prices. With **Keep in sync with the original**, every time you save the original the copy updates by itself; the copy shows a notice and a **Stop syncing** button. The copy has its own ID: changing one never deletes the other.
- **Delete** sends it to the **trash**, where you can recover it for 30 days before it's removed automatically.

05

Sub-recipes

A base sauce, a stock or a dough you use in many dishes. You create it once and use it like any other ingredient.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. Creating a sub-recipe
2. What's different in a sub-recipe
3. Everything updates in a chain
4. Sub-recipes with a sale price

Creating a sub-recipe

Create the recipe as usual and give it the classification **“Sub-recipe”**. When you save it, Gastrometrics creates an ingredient with the same name that you can search for and add to any other recipe sheet.

COST OF USE

Cost of use = Total cost of the sub-recipe ÷ Yield

It's what each unit of the preparation costs (each gram of sauce, for example) when you use it in another recipe.

What's different in a sub-recipe

It usually isn't sold on its own, so its summary shows just three figures: **production cost**, **yield** and **cost of use**. If you also sell it separately, you can type a sale price by hand in “Unit sale price”.

Everything updates in a chain

If an ingredient in your base sauce goes up, its cost of use recalculates and the change reaches every dish that uses it automatically, at any level (including sub-recipes that use another sub-recipe). Those dishes follow the “price only goes up” rule. Saving the sub-recipe also instantly recalculates the recipes that use it. You don't need to open any recipe.

Sub-recipes with a sale price

If you typed a sale price by hand on a sub-recipe and its cost goes up, the app asks whether you also want to raise that price to the suggested one: **Yes, update all**, **Choose one by one** or **No, costs only**. With “Remember my choice” it won't ask again for those sub-recipes. To change or uncheck it, open the sub-recipe and pick under **“Sale price when the cost goes up”**: Ask me every time, Always update or Never update.

Watch the quantities

Cost of use is usually per gram or milliliter. If you type “150” thinking of units instead of grams, the dish's cost shoots up. Check the unit before saving.

06

Bar and drinks

Wine, beer, cocktails and non-alcoholic drinks are costed just like food: they're ingredients and recipes with a few bar adjustments. There's no separate module to learn.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. Drinks as ingredients
2. Drink recipe sheets
3. Cocktails in the Recipe Sheet
4. Sell by the glass or bottle
5. Counting the bar
6. Kitchen and bar in Reports

Drinks as ingredients

Enter each bottle, can or keg as an ingredient, in milliliters or liters, with its price and content. There are bar categories of their own, each with its typical waste (spills, bottom of the bottle, foam):

CATEGORY	TYPICAL WASTE	SERVED AS
Spirits	2 %	Shot 45 ml, double 90 ml, bottle
Wine	5 %	Glass 150 or 125 ml, carafe 500 ml, bottle
Draft beer	18 %	Pint 473 ml, half liter, glass 330 ml
Bottled beer	0 %	Whole bottle or can
Soft drinks & mixers	2 %	Whole container or glass 250 ml

Drink recipe sheets

At the top of the Recipe Sheet you choose **Food** or **Drink**. Both use the same ingredients, the same cost and the same sub-recipe cascade, and they work the same in My Recipes, menus, POS, inventory and reports. When you choose Drink, you choose how it's sold:

TYPE	FOR	HOW IT'S COSTED
Prepared	Cocktails, lemonades, coffee drinks, smoothies and syrups	A recipe with several ingredients, like a dish
By measure	A glass of wine, a shot, a pint of draft beer or a 1.5 L soda by the glass	Milliliters served × price per milliliter
By package	Cans, bottled beer and water	The purchase price of one package

1. With **By measure** or **By package**, pick the ingredient in “Product and measure” (bar ingredients come first).
2. Pick the size of each serving (150 ml glass, shot, pint…) or “Other amount” in milliliters.
3. You see the package content, how many servings it gives and what each one costs. The suggested price comes from the target pour cost, as with any drink.
4. Save: if you didn't name it, it's named for you, for example “Malbec · 150 ml”.

“Product and measure” only shows **drinks** (ingredients with a bar category: wine, spirits, beer, soft drinks and mixers) and, by measure, only those in ml, L, oz or gallons; “Also show other ingredients” opens the rest. Measures come in the unit of your database: if you saved the bottle in ounces, you'll see a 5 oz glass, a 1.5 oz shot or a 16 oz pint.

The **Service** card keeps the glass, ice, garnish and method (shaken, stirred, built, blended, layered or brewed), so everyone behind the bar serves it the same way. It's printed in all three recipe-sheet PDFs, and the pricing method says “Pour Cost”.

Bar **syrups, cordials, infusions and mixes** are prepared drinks with the sub-recipe classification and a yield in ml or L. If sugar goes up, the syrup goes up and so does every cocktail that uses it. In My Recipes, the “Food and drinks” filter shows just one of the two.

> **Plan**
> Drink recipe sheets: every plan, Foodie included.

Cocktails in the Recipe Sheet

A cocktail is a recipe with its lines in milliliters. When you pick a **Bar · …** classification, the price is calculated with **pour cost**: the share of the price that is product cost. That target belongs to that recipe only: it doesn't change your dishes' target.

CLASSIFICATION	DEFAULT POUR COST	TYPICAL RANGE
Bar · Cocktails	20 %	15–22 %
Bar · Wine	30 %	25–35 %
Bar · Beer	24 %	20–28 %
Bar · Non-alcoholic	15 %	10–20 %
Bar · Coffee & tea	20 %	15–25 %

PRICE OF A DRINK

Price = Cost per serving ÷ Target pour cost

It's rounded up to your currency's step, like any suggested price.

EXAMPLE · GIN AND TONIC (IN DOLLARS)

Gin, 45 ml	1.69
Tonic, 150 ml	0.55
Lime	0.10
Cost of the drink	**2.34**
2.34 ÷ 0.22 = 10.64 → rounded	**11.00**

Sell by the glass or bottle

1. In **Ingredients**, find the drink and tap the **glass** icon on its row.
2. Choose how it's served: a measure (glass, shot, pint…), another amount in milliliters or the whole container.
3. Check the cost per serving, how many servings each container gives and the suggested price; you can type your own price.
4. Tap **Create recipe**: it appears in My Recipes and can be used right away in menus, sales and theoretical stock.

COST PER SERVING

Cost per serving = Milliliters served × Price per milliliter

Servings per container = Usable content ÷ Milliliters served

The price per milliliter already includes the ingredient's waste. Selling the whole bottle costs exactly its purchase price.

EXAMPLE · GLASS OF WINE

750 ml bottle	20.00
With 5 % waste you have	712.5 ml
Price per milliliter	0.028
150 ml glass	**4.21**
Glasses per bottle	4.75

Counting the bar

When you record inventory by pack you can use decimals (2.3 bottles). In the Inventory table, drinks show their stock, their minimum and the last count's difference in bottles too.

COUNT BY WEIGHT

Open fraction = (Weight − Empty) ÷ (Full − Empty)

Containers = Unopened + Open fraction

Tap the **scale** icon when counting. You weigh an unopened full bottle and an empty one of the same product just once; they're saved for future counts.

What the count tells you

In a bar, actual cost usually ends up several points above theoretical because of spills, over-pouring or comps. The count's difference, in bottles, tells you where to look first.

Kitchen and bar in Reports

In Reports → Finance, the **Kitchen vs. bar** card shows each area's sales, share of sales and theoretical cost, plus the actual cost if you did an opening and a closing count in the period. Menu Engineering has an All / Kitchen / Bar filter to compare drinks with drinks and dishes with dishes.

Below it, **Pour cost by drink type** splits cocktails, wine, beer, soft drinks and coffee: sales, theoretical cost and pour cost for each type, against the average target of your recipe sheets (orange when it's above).

Plan

Bar recipes and “Sell by the glass”: all plans. Waste by category: every plan; custom waste: from **Home Cook**. Inventory: from **Chef de Partie**. Kitchen vs. bar in Finance: from **Sous Chef**.

07

Chef de Partie plan or higher

Inventory

Know what you have, what's running out and what your storeroom is worth. Every count is kept as history.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. Statuses: normal, low and critical
2. Registering inventory
3. What your inventory is worth
4. Theoretical stock: how much should be left
5. Losses and shortages

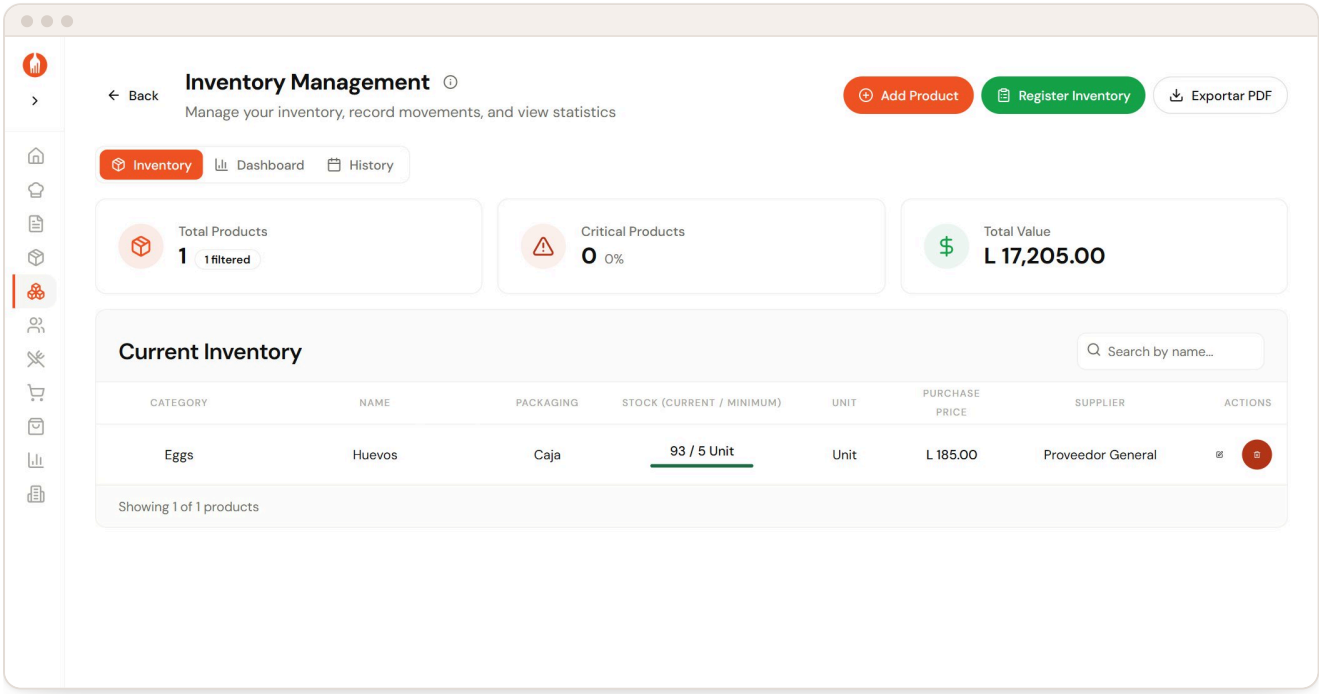


Figure 7 Inventory: current stock, minimums, the status of each item and total value.

Statuses: normal, low and critical

Each item has a **minimum** you set yourself, right in the table. The app uses it to mark its status:

STATUS	WHEN IT APPEARS
Critical	Stock is equal to or below the minimum.
Low	Stock is equal to or below twice the minimum.
Normal	Stock is above twice the minimum, or it hasn't been counted yet.

Registering inventory

"Register Inventory" saves a snapshot of your stock at that moment and updates current quantities. There are three types:

COUNT

Initial Inventory

What you have at the start of a shift, week or month.

COUNT

Final Inventory

What's left at the end of the period, to compare with the initial count.

STOCK IN

New Purchase

Goods that just arrived, with the price you paid. Updates your recipe costs if the price changed.

You can count in the base unit (grams, for example) or by pack (3 sacks), and the app does the conversion. When counting by pack you can use decimals: 2.3 bottles means 2 full ones and 3 tenths of the open one. The real content of the container is always counted, even if the ingredient has waste.

Reading the count from a photo, PDF or Excel

In the ingredients step, "Photo of the count" or "Upload file (photo, PDF or Excel)" read your count sheet: each line with a name and a quantity ("Flour 25 kg", "Olive oil … 3") is matched with an ingredient in your database and its quantity fills in automatically, converted to the ingredient's unit (if the line has no unit, the ingredient's unit is used). Lines that don't match any ingredient are listed so you can enter them by hand. Check the quantities in the table before saving.

Plan

Counting from a photo, PDF or Excel comes with Inventory (from **Chef de Partie**).

What your inventory is worth

INVENTORY VALUE

Item value = Stock × Container price ÷ Container content

Total value = Sum of all items

Stock is stored in the ingredient's unit (ml, g…) and the price is for the whole bottle, sack or box: that's why it's divided by its content. Three 750 ml bottles at 20 are worth 60.

With every new purchase the app also keeps a **weighted average cost** as a valuation reference. Recipe costing always uses the price of the latest purchase.

Automatic recalculation

If a purchase changes an ingredient's price, every recipe and sub-recipe that uses it recalculates, and the app tells you how many.

Prices only go up

If an ingredient's cost rises and a recipe's price falls short, the recipe moves up to the new suggested price. If the cost drops, the price does not drop: it stays as if you had typed it in «Unit selling price», and the app tells you in Notifications how much your margin rose. To lower it, change it yourself in the Recipe Sheet. For a sub-recipe with a hand-written sale price, the app asks you first (see Sub-recipes).

Theoretical stock: how much should be left

Besides the counted stock, each item shows its **theoretical stock**: what should be left based on the sales you recorded after the last count (manual, POS and invoices). Gastrometrics expands every sale through its recipe —including sub-recipes and waste— and deducts it automatically. Editing or deleting a sale corrects the number instantly.

THEORETICAL STOCK

Theoretical stock = Last count + Purchases received − Sales consumption

A dish sold consumes one portion of its recipe; a menu sold, one portion of each active dish.

Each product's traffic light uses the **theoretical stock** when there is one (a count plus sales or purchases recorded afterwards). So a product shows as low or critical even if the last count had plenty, when sales since then have used it up. Without theoretical stock, it uses what was counted.

When you do a new count, you'll see the **last count difference**: what you counted minus what the theory expected. If it's negative, more went out than your recipes explain (waste, waste, larger portions or missing stock): that's your cue to look into it.

Losses and shortages

What's lost outside of sales —a spill, a broken bottle, a courtesy poured without going through the POS or something expired— is logged in the product's panel with **Record a loss**: choose the reason, the quantity (with bottles and cans, ¼, ½ or 1 package in one tap) and a note. It's taken off the stock and the theoretical stock deducts it.

UNEXPLAINED SHORTAGE

Should be = Previous count + Purchases received − Sales usage − Recorded losses

Shortage = What you counted − What there should be

Example: there should be 1800 ml of rum and you counted 1500 ml: 300 ml are missing with no explanation. If the bottle costs L 300 for 750 ml, that's L 120.

The Inventory tab **Shortages and losses** (and Reports → Waste) shows in money what's missing with no explanation at your last count and what was lost by reason. With drinks, **Bar only** shows just the bar. What's missing with no explanation is usually over-pouring, unrecorded spills or unregistered courtesies. Items voided in the POS are already deducted.

08

Chef de Partie plan or higher

Menus

Group your recipes into courses to build a menu, a daily special or an event, with its average price and purchase order.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. Creating a menu in 4 steps
2. Export and purchase
3. MEP · Mise en place
4. By menu course or by kitchen area

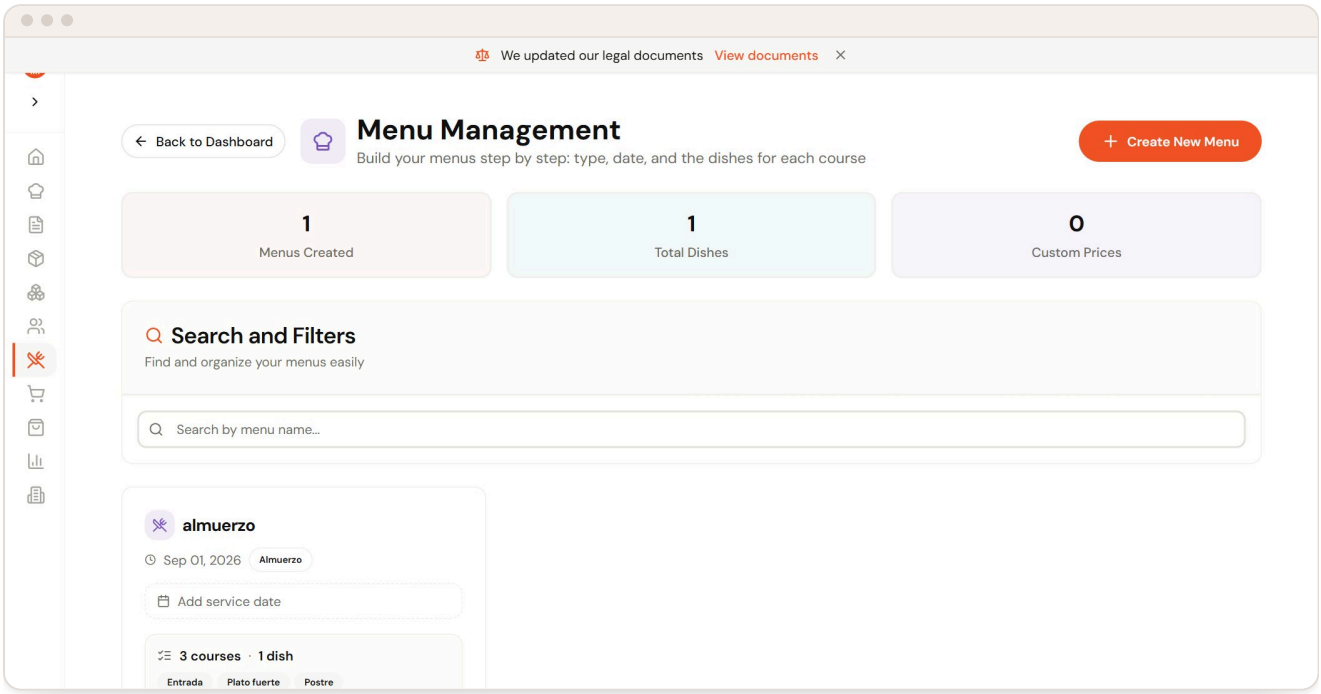


Figure 8 Menus: each menu with its courses, active dishes and average price.

Creating a menu in 4 steps

1. **Details**: name, type (lunch, dinner, brunch, buffet, tasting, catering, special event or other), date and number of guests.
2. **Courses**: Starter, Main and Dessert by default. You can rename, remove or add more.
3. **Dishes**: the app suggests first the recipes whose “Course” matches each one.
4. **Review**: the full summary, with the option to set how many portions of each dish you need for that service.

Drinks menu

Pick the **Drinks menu** type and the courses change to Cocktails, Wines, Beers and Non-alcoholic drinks. Each one suggests the recipes with the matching bar classification (chapter 6).

Each dish can have its own price (otherwise it uses its recipe sheet price) and can be temporarily turned off without removing it from the menu.

MENU AVERAGE PRICE

Average price = Sum of active dish prices ÷ Number of active dishes

Dishes that are turned off don't count.

The **full menu price** is the sum of the active dishes: it's what you charge if you record the sale of the whole menu (a set menu, for example). If you sell single dishes, each uses its own price. The average price is for comparing, not for charging.

Export and purchase

From each menu you can export the PDF for your guests or the internal version with costs (chapter 12), or generate the purchase order with everything needed to produce it.

MEP · Mise en place

In the side menu, **MEP** (or the "View MEP (mise en place)" button on each menu) shows everything you need to make for a menu. By menu course, each **dish** is a heading with its checkbox and, below it, its **sub-recipes** as a checklist, with the amount that dish needs (and, further in, the sub-recipes of each sub-recipe). If a sub-recipe is also used in another dish, it tells you. Tap any of them to see its ingredients with scaled amounts, the procedure and a link to its sheet. At the end, **Total per sub-recipe** adds up all dishes, in case you make it at once.

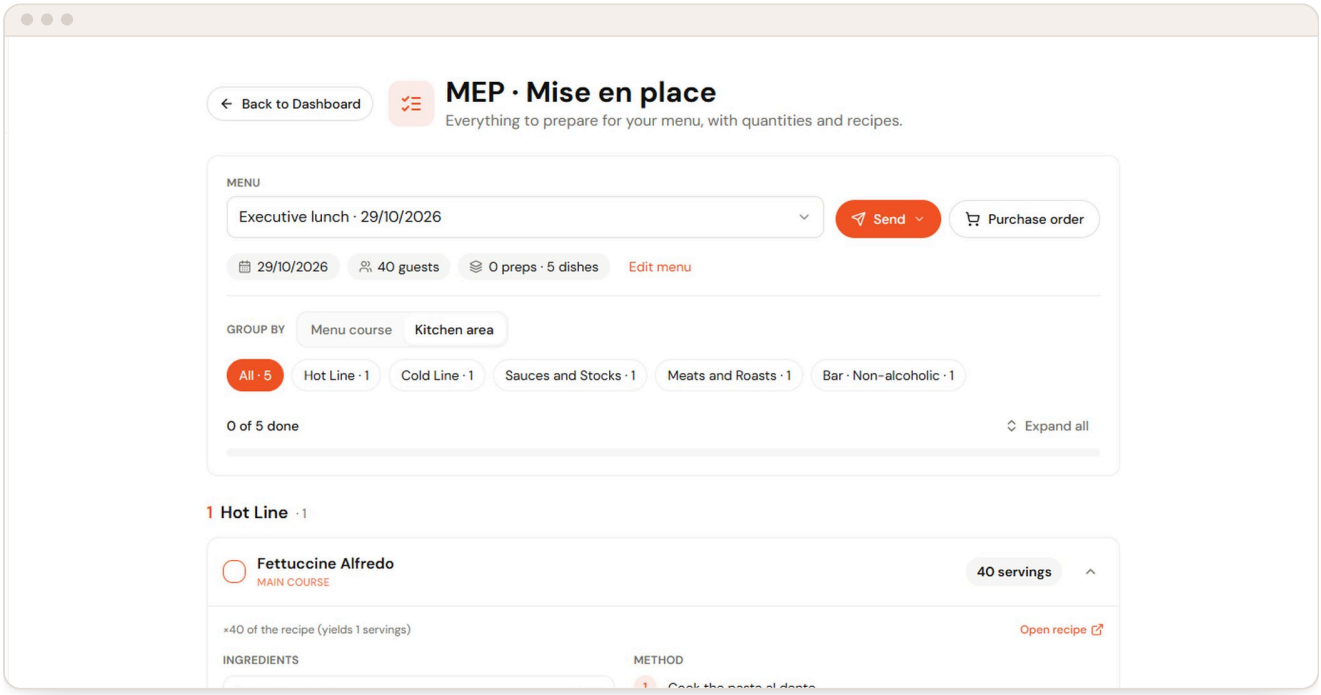


Figure 9 MEP: what to prepare for the menu, grouped by kitchen area, with a recipe open and its quantities already scaled.

- **Portions**: the ones you set for each dish in the menu; otherwise, the menu's guest count.
- **Base preps**: they come first because they're made earlier; preps used by other preps appear above them.

- **Done**: check each row when it's ready; progress is remembered on that device and can be reset.

HOW MUCH TO MAKE

Multiplier = Menu portions ÷ Recipe yield

Quantity = Quantity in the recipe × Multiplier

Each quantity is rounded up with the same rule as the Recipe Sheet's PAX modifier, so you never come up short.

By menu course or by kitchen area

With "Group by" you choose to see the MEP by **menu course** (starter, main course…) or by **kitchen area**, which are the Recipe Sheet classifications (hot line, cold line, sauces and stocks, pastry, bar…). Tap an area to see only its items.

One sheet per station

The **Send** button downloads, prints or sends by WhatsApp or email exactly what you're viewing. The PDF starts with the list and checkboxes, then one recipe per page. Grouped by area, each area starts on a new sheet: print it and hand each station its own.

09

Purchase Orders

Tell each supplier exactly what and how much you need: by hand, from a menu or a recipe, or by letting the app suggest it from your inventory.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. Four ways to create an order
2. Statuses and receiving
3. Send to the supplier

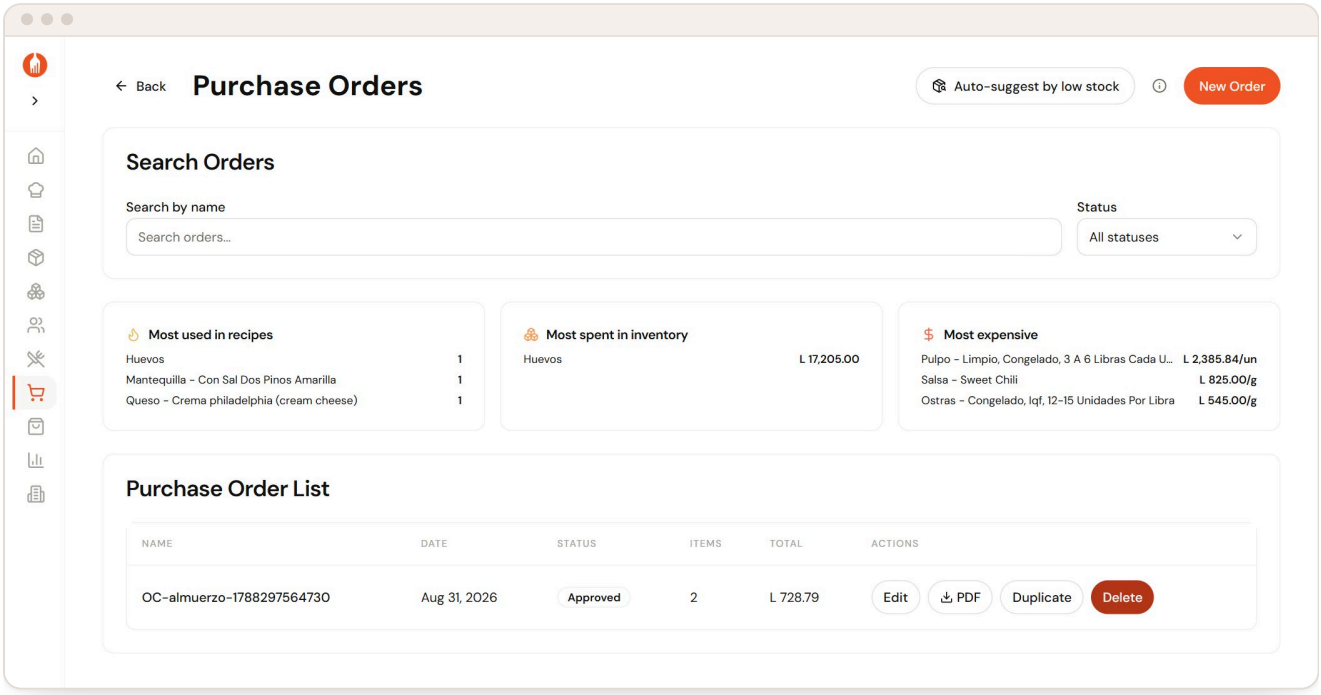


Figure 10 Purchase Orders: the automatic low-stock suggestion and the list of orders with their status.

Four ways to create an order

- **By hand**: search for each ingredient and the app fills in its unit, supplier and price.
- **Suggested from low stock**: checks your inventory and builds the order with everything that's low or critical.
- **From a menu**: everything needed to produce it, minus what you already have.
- **From a recipe**: the "Generate Purchase Order" button in the Recipe Sheet, already scaled if you use the PAX modifier.

SUGGESTED QUANTITY FOR LOW STOCK

Quantity to order = Larger of (2 × Minimum − Current stock) and the Minimum

It restocks up to twice your minimum to give you headroom, and never suggests less than the minimum itself.

ORDER TOTAL

Line cost = Quantity × Price per unit

Total = Sum of lines + Tax

Tax is 0 % by default and you can change it. If the ingredient has a pack, the order also tells you how many packs to buy, rounding up.

Statuses and receiving

Pending · Approved · Ordered · Received · Cancelled

You can change the status freely. Items are grouped by supplier (those without a supplier go last) so you can call each one with their full list. You can also duplicate or edit an order.

"Received" adds to your inventory

When you mark an order as received, its quantities are added automatically to the stock of those items in inventory (matched by ingredient, even if you renamed it, or by name). If a product isn't in Inventory, the app tells you which. Sales tax, notes and the delivery date are kept when you edit the order. If what arrived differs from the order, correct it by recording the real amounts in **Inventory → New Purchase**.

Send to the supplier

Each order's **Send** button shares it by **WhatsApp** (a message with the list; you pick the chat) or by **email** (the PDF downloads and your email opens so you choose who and attach it). On a phone, "Share PDF…" sends it with the PDF attached to the app you choose. The **PDF** button still downloads it as always.

If a new order has ingredients from several suppliers, **Create one order per supplier** creates them all at once, one per supplier, each with its own subtotal and the tax split proportionally. It also works with the suggested order.

Plan

Manual orders are available from **Home Cook**; automatic suggestions from **Chef de Partie**.

10

Sales and invoices

Record what you sell to compare your prices with reality: by hand, by importing your point-of-sale (POS) system or by issuing invoices to your customers.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. Recording sales
2. Checks and tables
3. Cash-up
4. Invoices for your customers
5. Sales history

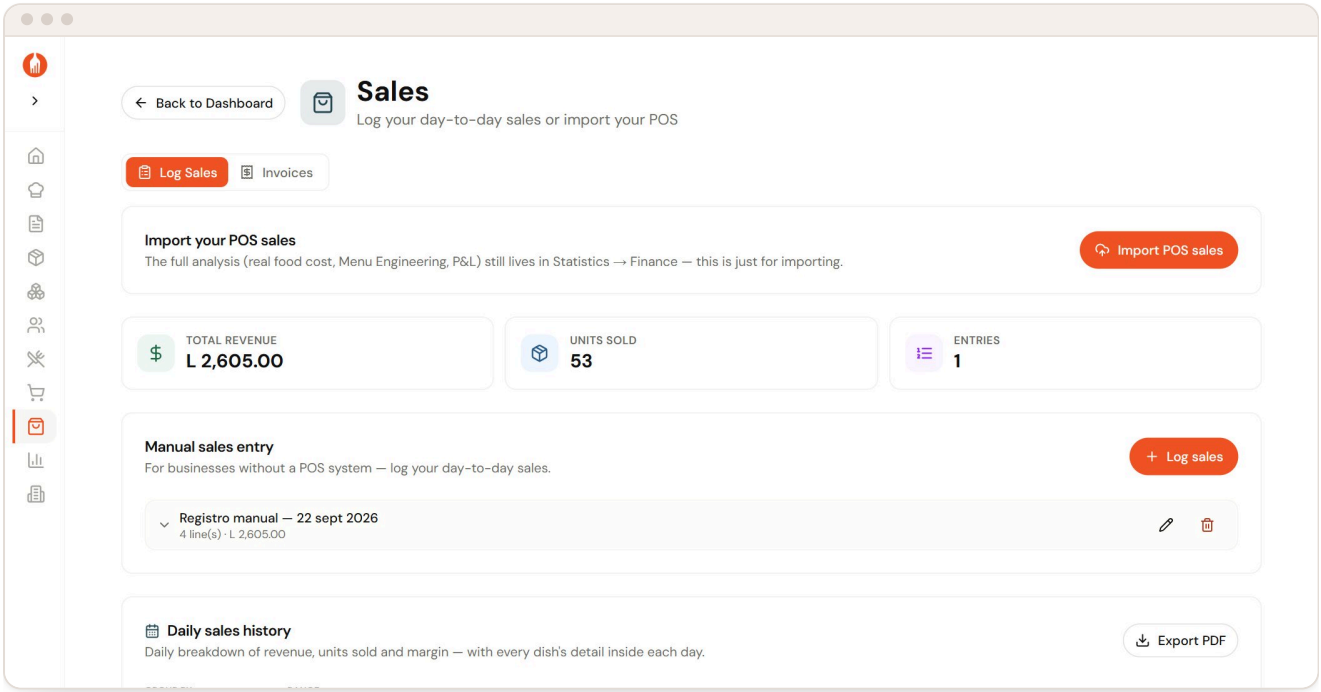


Figure 11 Sales: POS import and manual entry in one place.

Recording sales

- **Manual entry**: ideal if you don't have a POS. Each day has its **checks**: search for the dish or menu (or tap one of your best sellers) and adjust the quantity with - and +. The price comes from its Recipe Sheet and you can change it; the app calculates revenue and cost. If that day already has sales, it offers to add to that entry.
- **Import your POS**: upload an .xlsx, .xls, .csv or .txt file. You tell it once which column is the dish, quantity, date and price, and save that as a named template. Next time, the app recognizes it on its own.
- **Modifiers or add-ons**: if your POS has a column such as “Extra cheese, 2x Bacon”, pick it when you import. Link each add-on to a small recipe (for example “Extra cheese” with 30 g of cheese): its cost is added to the dish and its ingredients come out of theoretical inventory. They don't add to sales, because they're already in the dish price, and removals (“No onion”) aren't counted. The link is remembered for next time.

Tricky files

The app detects whether your dates come as day/month or month/day (and lets you correct it), and reads accents and special characters correctly from older Windows-format files.

Checks and tables

- **Channel**: Dine-in, Takeaway, Delivery or Bar. For Dine-in and Bar you note the **table** (a number or a name, like "Patio 2"); tables you've used before show up to tap.
- **Guests, time, server and payment** (cash, card, transfer or other): all optional. **Repeat check** copies the dishes to another table.
- **Discount** and **tip**: the discount is taken off the sale (spread across the check's dishes); the tip is kept separately and doesn't count as a sale. If you don't need the detail, use a single check for the whole day.

BY TABLE

Check total = Subtotal − Discount

Average check = Sales ÷ Checks

Spend per guest = Sales ÷ Guests

Below the entries, "By table" shows for 7, 30 or 90 days which tables sell most and how sales split by channel, server, payment and time. Spend per guest only uses checks with guests noted.

Cash-up

1. At closing, tap **Cash-up** on that day's sales entry.
2. Enter the **opening float** (the change you opened with) and any **cash payouts** (purchases or payments made with drawer money).
3. Count the cash and enter the **counted cash**, float included.
4. Enter the **terminal total** from the batch close, or tap **Read photo** and snap the slip: the app reads the total (the photo never leaves your phone). Check that it's right.
5. Enter the **transfers received** and tap **Save cash-up**.

CASH-UP

Expected cash = Opening float + Cash sales + Cash tips − Cash payouts

Expected terminal = Card sales + Card tips

Difference = Actual − Expected

Expected amounts come from the day's checks by payment method. If cash tips don't stay in the drawer, or card tips aren't charged on the terminal, turn that off and they aren't added. A negative difference is money short; positive, money over. If the total matches but one payment method doesn't, it's almost always a check with the wrong payment method.

If one payment method is short and another is over (for example, cash -100 and card terminal +80), the cash-up marks it as mixed and shows each difference separately, plus the total (-20). It's usually a check recorded with the wrong payment method; if something is still missing after fixing it, it's a real shortage.

Shortages and days without a cash-up
The “Cash-ups” card shows for 7, 30 or 90 days how many days were closed, total shortages and overages, days with a difference and days still to close. From the cash-up you can download the PDF or send it on WhatsApp. Checks without a payment method aren't included: add it in the day's entry.

Invoices for your customers

In the **Invoices** tab you create the invoice you hand to your customer: pick recipes or menus (or type lines by hand), with automatic numbering, editable tax, notes and your business logo on the PDF. Each invoice automatically counts as a sale in your reports (without tax).

Not an official tax invoice
The Gastrometrics invoice doesn't include numbering authorized by any tax authority. Check your country's requirements before using it as a tax document.

Sales history

At the bottom of the page, the history brings together all your sales (manual, POS and invoices), grouped by day, week, month or year, for the date range you choose, with a button to export it to PDF.

Plan
Invoices: from **Home Cook**. Manual entry: from **Chef de Partie**. POS import: from **Sous Chef**.

11

POS

Your point of sale inside GastroMetrics: your floor plan, orders by table and seat with a photo of each dish, the kitchen screen and checkout. What you charge is saved in Sales automatically.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. Always inside a business
2. Set up your floor
3. Take an order
4. Kitchen
5. Priced extras
6. If something goes wrong
7. Check out

Always inside a business

The POS works in one business at a time: each one has its own floor, menu, extras, cash-up, sales and reports, and nothing is mixed. Your **main space** is the account's first business (your recipes and menus live there); if you created other businesses in Businesses, you choose which one to work in when you open the POS. With only one, it opens straight away, and from a business's sidebar it opens that business's POS. At the top you see which business you're in and can **Switch business**. A team member with access to a single business only sees that business's POS. In a new business, under **Settings**, **Copy the main-space floor plan** brings its areas, tables and extras.

Set up your floor

1. Go to **POS → Settings**. The first time it comes with one area and 6 sample tables.
2. Create your **areas** (dining room, terrace, bar) with **New area**.
3. Add **square, round or long** tables and drag them into place; they snap to the grid.
4. Tap a table to change its **number or name**, shape and **seats**, duplicate it or delete it.

Take an order

1. On the **Floor** tab, tap the table. The color shows how it's going: free, occupied, a dish ready (green) or asking for the bill.
2. Choose who it's for: a **seat** or **For the table** (to share).
3. Tap **Add dish** and choose the **menu**: one of your menus (its dishes by course plus the whole menu) or **All my recipes** (by classification). There's a search, and your last menu is remembered. Dishes whose recipe has a photo show it; the rest show just the name and price. Choose the quantity, the **extras** and a note (“no onion”).
4. Tap **Send to kitchen**. What's already in the kitchen can't be edited; what's noted can.

Takeaway orders start with **New takeaway**. Several people can use the POS at once from different devices: the screen refreshes every few seconds.

Above the floor plan, the **summary** counts free, occupied, dish-ready and bill-requested tables, plus the open total, in the same colors as the plan. The tabs show a number: **Floor**, tables with dishes ready; **Kitchen**, orders waiting. In the order, the big button changes with what's next: add the first dish, **Send to kitchen** when there are new dishes, or **Check out** when the bill was requested. In the menu, each dish's **+** adds it in one tap (no extras or note) and the menu stays open to keep ordering; **Done** closes it. The server's name is remembered on each device.

Kitchen

The **Kitchen** tab shows what needs preparing, oldest table first, with the seat, extras, notes and minutes waiting (orange from 15). When you tap **Ready**, the floor sees the table in green and the server marks it **Served**.

Priced extras

In **Settings → Extras** you create extras like "Extra cheese" with a price and, optionally, a recipe. Offer them on every dish or only some classifications. What you sell comes from your menus and My Recipes: to keep something off a menu, remove it from that menu.

There are two ways to create an extra: **From a recipe** opens your recipes and sub-recipes with their cost and price; when you pick one, the extra takes its name and price (you can change them), and its cost and ingredients count in every sale. **Custom extra** creates one by hand, which you can also link to a recipe later.

If something goes wrong

Void a dish already sent to the kitchen: in the order, tap **Void** on that dish and choose what happened. **Not prepared**: no ingredients used. **Prepared and wasted** or **On the house**: ingredients are used (they come out of theoretical inventory) and the cost shows in Reports → Finance, under "Voids and comps". What you haven't sent yet is removed with "-".

Offline: if the internet drops, what you enter stays on screen and is kept on the device; at the top you'll see "Offline: N tables with changes to save". It saves on its own when the connection is back, or with **Retry now**. A table with unsaved changes can't be checked out until they're saved.

Two devices on the same table: if the floor adds a dish while the kitchen marks another ready, both changes are saved; when that happens you'll see "Merged with another device". If the table was already charged on another device, it tells you.

Protected checkout: if something fails right when charging, tap **Check out** again: the bill isn't added to Sales twice, and two devices charging on the same day add their bills to the same daily record.

PRICE OF A DISH WITH EXTRAS

$$\text{Price} = \text{Dish price} + \Sigma\,(\text{Extra price} \times \text{Quantity})$$

$$\text{Cost} = \text{Dish cost} + \Sigma\,(\text{Extra recipe cost} \times \text{Quantity})$$

Unlike extras imported from another POS, in the POS the extra's price does add to the sale. If the extra is linked to a recipe, its ingredients also come out of theoretical inventory.

Check out

1. Tap **Check out** on the table.
2. Choose **Whole bill** or only some seats: what you don't charge stays on the table.
3. Choose the payment method and enter any discount and tip.
4. Tap **Charge**: the bill is added to today's sales record, with its table, server, time and payment method, and shows up in the cash-up, history and reports.

> **Not a tax invoice**
> The POS doesn't issue tax invoices or receipts authorized by a tax authority. Check what your country requires.

> **Plan**
> POS: from **Sous Chef**. In Team it's given with the **POS** permission, which includes “Manual sales entry” because checkout is saved there.

12

Reports

This is where your numbers make sense: which recipes earn the most, what your inventory is worth and how your business is really doing.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. Overview
2. Finance
3. Suppliers
4. Waste

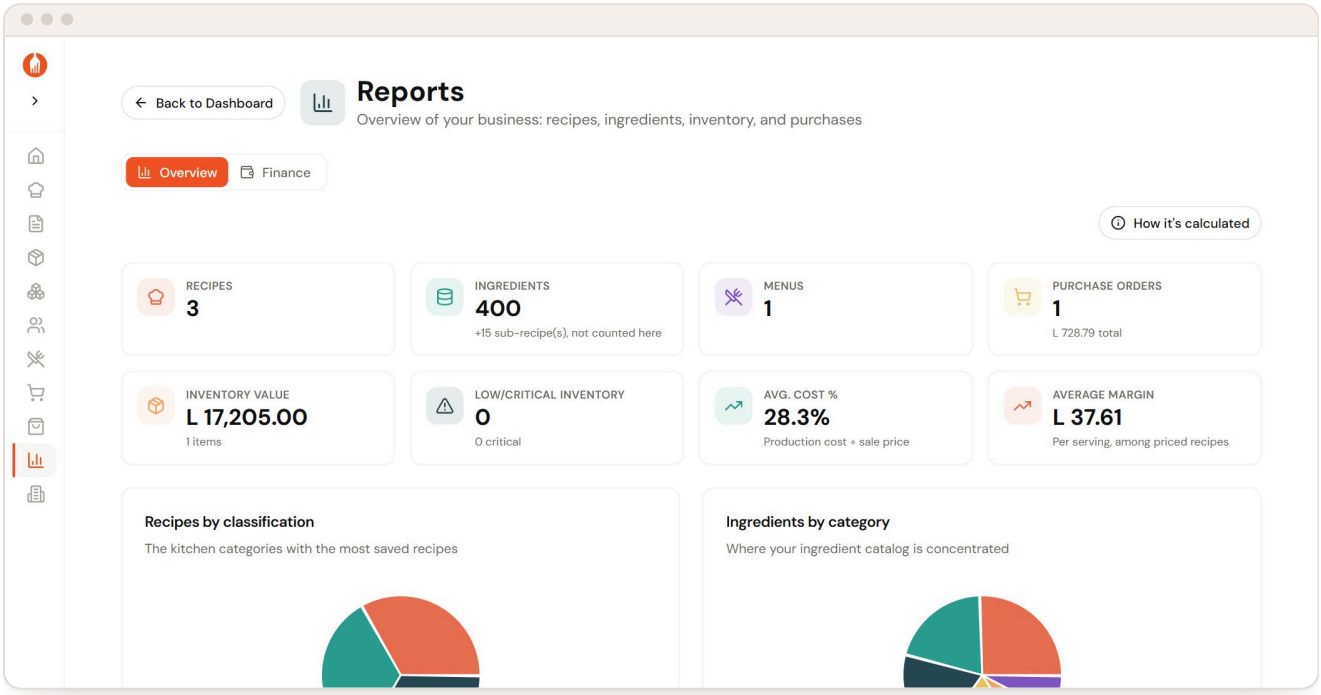


Figure 12 Reports: a business overview with its indicators and charts.

Overview

General counts, inventory value and items on alert, average cost and margin, recipes by classification, most-used ingredients and the recipes with the best and worst margin. Cost % and margin are measured as on the Recipe Sheet: without the sales tax included in the price and after commission.

Finance

If you sell drinks, the **Kitchen vs. bar** card separates sales, theoretical cost and actual cost for each area (chapter 6). Profit and loss statement (P&L), your theoretical food cost (from your sales) versus the real one (which also needs an inventory count at the start and end of the period plus your purchases; without them the card says the count is missing), price changes by supplier, and **Menu Engineering**, which classifies each dish with Kasavana and Smith's standard method: it's popular if it sells at least 70% of its even share, and its margin is high if its margin per plate (price - cost) beats the average margin per plate sold. Cost percentages, Prime Cost and the P&L are measured on net sales, without the sales tax included in prices (same as the recipe sheet):

CATEGORY	POPULARITY	MARGIN	WHAT TO DO
Star	High	High	Protect it and feature it on your menu.
Cash cow	High	Low	It sells well: review its cost or raise its price a little.
Puzzle	Low	High	Good margin: promote it or improve its presentation.
Dog	Low	Low	Consider redesigning it or taking it off the menu.

COST OF GOODS SOLD (COGS)

COGS = Opening inventory + Purchases − Closing inventory

For an exact figure you need an opening and a closing count in the period.

Everything you record in Sales and charge in the POS also lands here: below the sales history, **By table** splits sales by table, channel, server, payment method and hour, with average ticket, spend per guest, tips and discounts; if you use the POS, it adds **extras sold** and the average **kitchen time**. Further down, the **Cash-ups** card sums up shortages, overages and days not cashed up; tapping a day opens it in Sales.

Suppliers

Each ingredient's price history and which supplier you bought it from, with a table comparing your suppliers (last price, lowest, number of purchases). It shows **where you could save** (another supplier sold it to you cheaper, with the estimated monthly saving), what went up the most in 30 days and a summary of each supplier. Prices come from your purchase orders (excluding cancelled), Inventory purchases, price changes and each ingredient's current price.

Waste

Information based on the waste you set in Ingredients (chapter 3), either its category's global value or a custom one: how much of what you buy is usable, how much more each unit costs, how much you lose on each purchase and an estimated monthly cost based on what you bought in the last 90 days. It also suggests ingredients without waste turned on whose category usually loses quite a bit.

Plan

Overview: from **Chef de Partie**. Finance: from **Sous Chef**.

13

PDF documents

Each document is designed for whoever will read it: your kitchen, your management, your supplier or your customer. Costs never mix with documents meant for outsiders.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. The 9 documents

The 9 documents

DOCUMENT	FOR	WHAT IT INCLUDES
Recipe sheet · Administrative	Owner and management	Ingredients with costs, cost items, charts, margin and food cost.
Recipe sheet · Kitchen	Your kitchen team	Ingredients, quantities, photo and procedure, with no money figures.
Recipe sheet · Quick	Suppliers or partners	The essentials of the recipe, without costs or prices.
Inventory	Management	Total value, value by category, top items and statuses.
Menu · Guest	Your diners	An elegant menu, with no cost figures.
Menu · Internal	Owner	Cost, price and margin per dish, with charts.
MEP · Mise en place	Each kitchen station	What to make and how much, with checkboxes, and one scaled recipe per page; by area, one sheet per station.
Purchase order	Suppliers	Ingredients by supplier, quantities and total.
Invoice	Your customer	Your logo, customer details, lines, tax and total.

Recipe sheets and the customer menu include each dish's allergens, calculated from its ingredients at the moment you export (chapter 3).

Automatic warnings
The administrative sheet warns you at the top if cost exceeds the selling price or if the yield looks mistyped, before you print an odd number.

PDFs come out in the language selected in the app, use your currency and carry your business's logo and theme color.

On the **Chef Ejecutivo** plan your PDFs don't show GastroMetrics: in Settings → Appearance → **Your PDFs** you write the name in the header (if you leave it empty, the business name is used) and a line at the bottom of each page, such as your address, phone or tax ID. It's saved per business and your team sees it too. On the other plans, PDFs carry GastroMetrics in the footer.

On every plan, the same section has your **business details**: legal name, tax ID, address, phone and email. They appear on your invoices and purchase orders. You also choose the **menu typeface** for the customer menu, classic or modern; the menu uses your business color.

> **Plan**
> The kitchen sheet is included in every plan. The administrative sheet, from **Home Cook**.

14

Sous Chef plan or higher

Team

Invite your team to work with you in Gastrometrics, each person with access only to what they need.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. Inviting someone

Inviting someone

In **Team** you enter the person's email. They receive an invitation and create their own account; your subscription covers their access. With Sous Chef you can add 1 person and with Chef Ejecutivo up to 4 (each plan's users include you). There are no fixed roles: you set three things separately for each person.

SETTING	OPTIONS
Scope	All your businesses, or just one.
Tools	Independent boxes: recipes, ingredients, waste, invoices, manual and automatic orders, inventory, menus, MEP, reports, sales entry, sales history and by-table view, cash-up, finance and managing the team. So a server can log checks without seeing the totals.
PDF	Applies to every PDF. None; for sharing, without costs (recipes, client menu, MEP, invoices and purchase orders); or administrative (plus recipe with costs, internal menu, inventory value and sales history).

> **Preview**
> Turn on preview to see the app exactly as that person would, with the same permissions.

Permissions are truly enforced, not just on screen: someone without access to a tool can't see or save that data. If something is locked, the app explains whether it's because of the account's plan or because the owner restricted it.

Your team works within your plan: if your plan expires, is cancelled or drops to one without Team, your invitees lose access to your businesses (nothing is deleted, neither their accounts nor your data). When you go back to a plan with Team, they get access back with the same permissions. They also can't use tools your plan doesn't include.

15

Plans and subscription

Start for free and move up when you need to. Your data is never lost when you change plans.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. Paying, changing or cancelling

PLAN	PRICE	BUSINESSES	USERS (INCL. YOU)	ADDS
Foodie	Free	1	1	Recipes, ingredients, import from wherever your data already is (text, Excel, PDF, photos and receipts) and kitchen recipe sheet PDF, drink recipe sheets and waste by category (included in every plan).
Home Cook	$15 / month	1	1	Custom waste, manual purchase orders, administrative sheet, invoices and price updates from receipts or lists.
Chef de Partie	$35 / month	1	1	Inventory (with counts from a photo, PDF or Excel), menus, suggested orders, Reports · Overview and manual sales entry.
Sous Chef	$70 / month	2	2	Reports · Finance, P&L, Menu Engineering, POS import and Team (you + 1 person).
Chef Ejecutivo	$120 / month	5	5	Team of up to 4 people besides you.

If your plan has an end date (for example, the founding kitchen month), the sidebar shows how many days are left under your plan. Three days before and on the day itself we remind you in the app: you can pick the plan you want to keep and **schedule the payment**, which is charged the day your plan ends. Your plan only changes once Stripe confirms the payment; otherwise your account switches to Foodie and you keep all your data.

Importing is free

Importing your recipes and ingredients from text, Excel, PDF (with text or scanned), photos or receipts is included in every plan, Foodie too, with no limit. What changes with the plan is what you do next: from Home Cook you can update the price of the ingredients you already have with a receipt or a list, and from Chef de Partie read your inventory counts.

My Plan brings everything together on one page: at the top, the **Your plan** card shows at a glance when your plan ends, your **next charge** (date and amount) and, if you earned months by inviting colleagues, from when to when they run. If nothing is scheduled, it shows the date your account would move to Foodie. Below it is "Give a month, get a month" (next chapter) and, at the end, **Change plan**.

At the bottom of My Plan is **Your account**: **Cancel subscription** (you keep your plan until the end of the paid period; then you move to Foodie, with no more charges and all your data), **Delete all content** (keeps the account and plan) and **Delete account** (30 days to reactivate it; after that everything is deleted). The last two ask you to type your email to confirm and are also in Settings.

We keep automatic copies of your data for up to 6 months. If you delete your content or your account by mistake, write to us in the support chat and we'll recover it, even into a new account with a different email. After 6 months the copies are deleted automatically.

We confirm every charge. When Stripe charges your plan you get a "Payment confirmed" email (amount, date, next charge and invoice) and see it when you open the app. If a charge can't be made, we tell you **nothing was charged** and you can update your card with one tap; Stripe tries again over the following days. The "Your plan" card shows your recent charges, paid or failed.

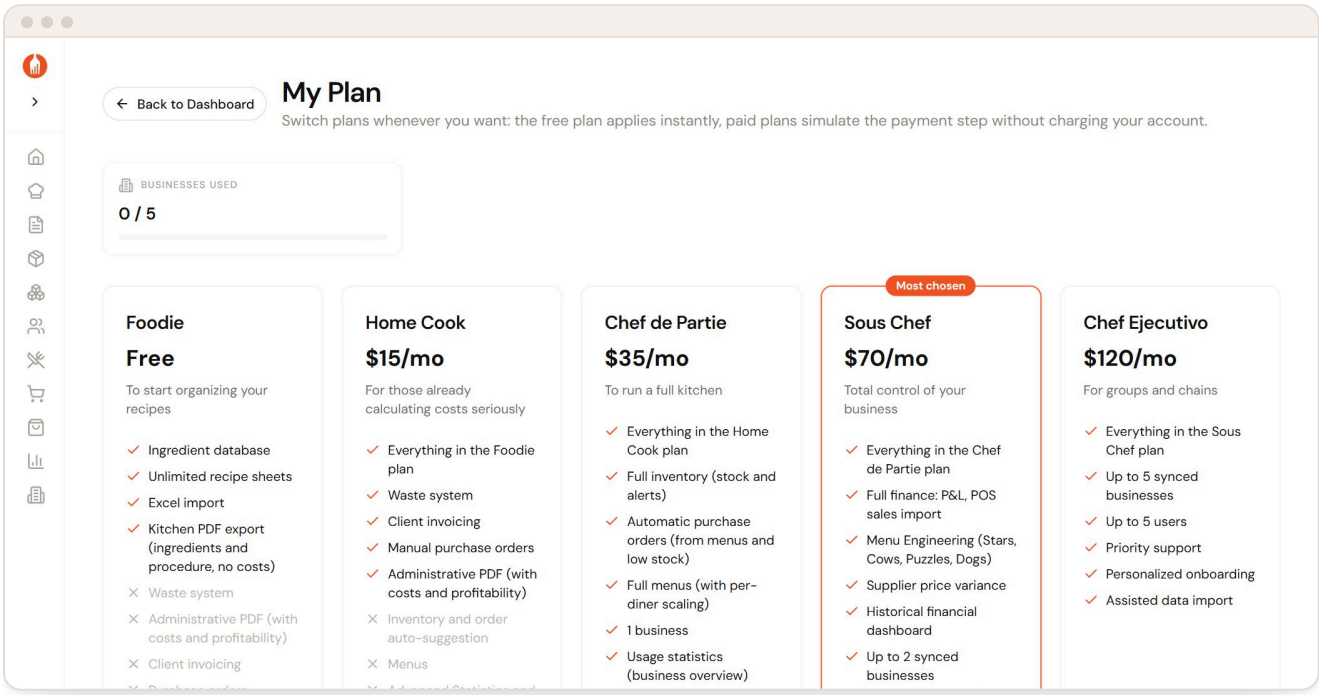


Figure 13 My Plan: your current plan, what it includes and how to manage your subscription.

Paying, changing or cancelling

If you move to a plan with fewer businesses or people than you have, we tell you before you confirm. The oldest stay active up to the limit. The other businesses are locked and you can only download what they contain, and the extra people lose access. Nothing is deleted: it all comes back if you change plans. The same happens if your plan expires or you cancel it.

Payments are processed by Stripe. From **My Plan** you can change plans or open the billing portal to update your card or cancel. Changes show up in your account automatically and you get a confirmation email.

Whenever your plan changes —because you changed it, because the Gastrometrics team adjusted it, or because an assigned plan expired— we let you know by email and with a window when you open the Dashboard, listing exactly what you **gain**, what you **lose** and what your plan includes now. If you lose access to a section, your data isn't deleted: it becomes available again if you upgrade later. The change also shows up under **Notifications** on the Dashboard and, when you close the window, a **short tour of**

your new plan starts: it points to each menu module with something new. If a module isn't visible yet because you need more recipes (chapter 2), the tour tells you how many you need instead of pointing to something hidden.

If you cancel, you keep full access until the end of the period you've already paid for. My Plan shows you the exact date.

If you change your mind before that date, tap **Keep my subscription** in the My Plan notice: the same subscription continues, renews on the same day and nothing extra is charged.

When switching from one paid plan to another, before confirming you see what you pay today and when and how much your next charge is. Upgrading, you pay today only the difference for the days left in the month; downgrading, nothing is charged and you get a credit that comes off your next charges. Your renewal date doesn't change. If the card declines, your plan stays the same and nothing is left pending.

If a monthly charge fails, My Plan shows "We couldn't process your last payment" with the **Update payment method** button. While Stripe retries, you keep using your plan; if it doesn't go through, your account moves to Foodie without losing data.

> **When something is locked**
> You'll see a padlock and a button to My Plan. If you use the app as part of a team, the message tells you it's the account owner who controls that access.

16

Invite: give a month, get a month

Invite another chef or kitchen to Gastrometrics. Your colleague tries it free and you earn a month when they really get started.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. How to invite
2. What each of you gets

How to invite

1. Open **My Plan**: "Give a month, get a month" is right below your plan. The **Invite** shortcut in the side menu takes you straight there.
2. Copy your link or send it with the WhatsApp or email buttons.
3. Your colleague signs up with that link: they see a note with your name and get 30 days of Chef Ejecutivo, no card.

What each of you gets

WHO	WHAT THEY GET
Your colleague	30 days of Chef Ejecutivo free, no card, no commitment. When it ends they go back to Foodie on their own, with no charge; if they want to continue, they pick a plan.
You	A month when your colleague really gets started within their first 30 days: saves a recipe with cost or picks a paid plan. Up to 12 months a year.

Your reward is **Chef Ejecutivo**, the most complete plan, and it never lowers your plan. On Foodie it starts today. If you already have a plan with an end date —for example, the founding-kitchen month— 30 days are added at the end and, if your plan was lower, you move up to Chef Ejecutivo. If you pay for your plan, you get one month of your plan as credit on your next invoice.

✓ **Reminders**

If your colleague hasn't started, we email you on day 3 and day 14. In Invite you see how many days they have left and can remind them on WhatsApp with one tap.

i **The rules, always at hand**

Tap the **?** next to the Invite title to see all the rules. If they don't get started within 30 days, the invitation expires. Only new accounts of real people count.

The program rules are also in the **Terms of Use, section 4.7**, and the Privacy Policy explains what the person who invited you sees: only your first name, sign-up date and invitation status, never your recipes or data.

17

Settings, language and emails

Make the app your own, choose your language and currency, decide which emails you get and manage your account data.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. The Settings tabs
2. Language and currency
3. Emails you can receive
4. Your data

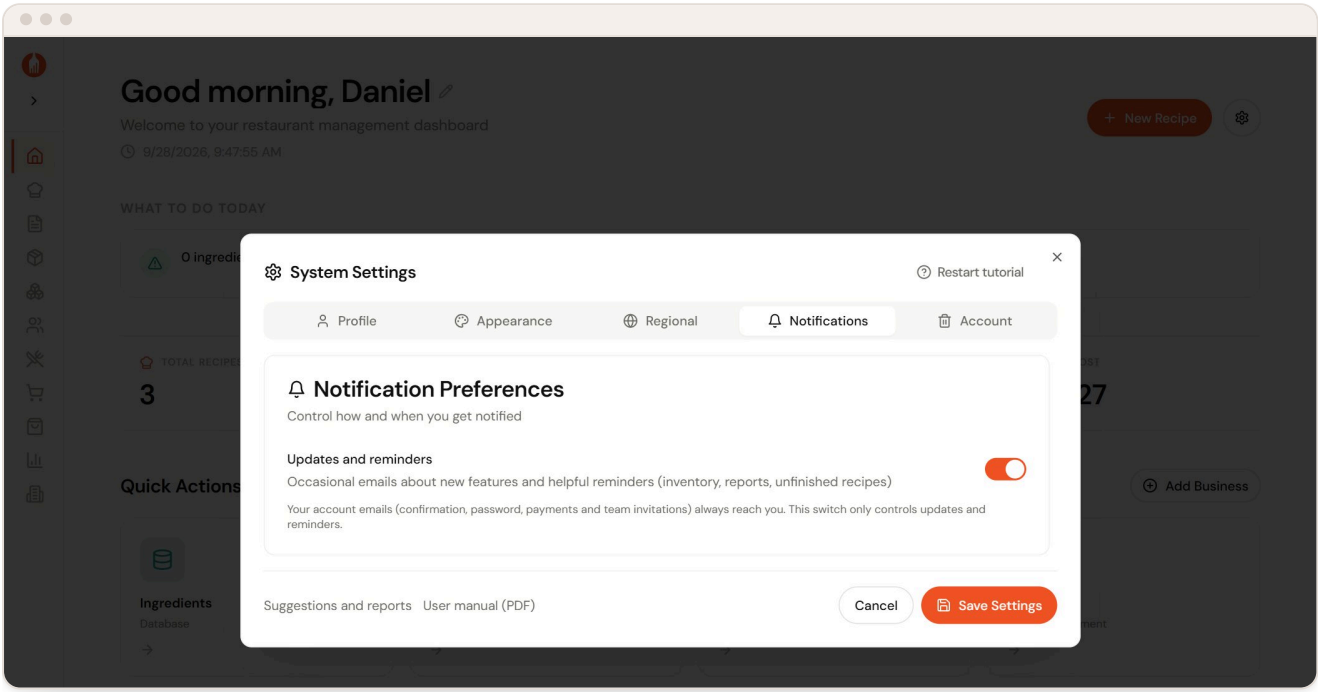


Figure 14 Settings → Notifications, where you decide whether to receive updates and reminders.

The Settings tabs

- **Profile**: name, email (changing it asks for your current password), country and business type.
- **Appearance**: light, dark or follow your system.
- **Regional**: country, currency and language.
- **Notifications**: whether you want product updates and reminders by email.
- **Account**: data backup, legal documents, delete content and delete the account.

Language and currency

The app is available in **Spanish, English, Danish, French, Portuguese and Chinese**. The language you choose is used across the interface, in your PDFs and in **every email** we send you. There are 21 currencies; changing currency changes the symbol and format, it doesn't convert your amounts. Decimals always use a point.

Emails you can receive

You always get your account emails: confirmation, password, payments and team invitations. If you turn on **Updates and reminders**, we'll also write when there are new features and, if you haven't signed in for a few days, a helpful reminder based on what you did last:

You can also get **alerts on your phone or computer**: turn them on in Settings → Notifications, on each device, or when you write to us in the chat. We only alert you to what matters: a chat reply, a failed charge, your plan about to end, a month earned by inviting, low stock and dishes losing margin. On iPhone, add GastroMetrics to your Home Screen from Safari and turn them on from there. When you sign out, that device stops receiving them.

REMINDER

Unfinished recipe

Your Recipe Sheet draft is waiting for you before the 24 hours are up.

REMINDER

Inventory and reports

When a week has passed since your last count or since you checked your reports.

REMINDER

Prices and coming back

If your prices haven't been updated in over 30 days, or if you haven't visited in a while.

And when your account has something specific to tell you, we email you the figure:

EVERY MONDAY

Weekly summary

Your key numbers: average food cost, inventory value, items below minimum and dishes with low margin.

ALERT

Low stock and margin

If an item reaches its minimum or a dish stops meeting its food cost target.

TEAM

Invitations and businesses

If your invitee hasn't joined, or a new business still has no recipes.

MILESTONES

Progress and your plan

When you reach 10, 25 or 50 recipes, and if your plan includes something you haven't tried yet.

We never send more than one reminder every few days. Every email has a link to unsubscribe in one click, or you can uncheck the box in Settings → Notifications.

Your data

- **Download backup**: a single .zip file with all your content: datos.json (ingredients, recipes, menus, inventory, orders, invoices and sales, with the cash-up already calculated), the recipe and menu PDFs, and a LEEME.txt in your language with the date, currency, how many records of each kind there are and what it doesn't include (passwords, payments, team and plan). It's a copy to keep: for now the app doesn't import it back automatically.
- **Delete all content**: empties your account but keeps it active. You type your email to confirm.
- **Delete account**: cancels your subscription and erases everything permanently. It also asks for your email to confirm.

No going back

Deleting content or the account can't be undone. Download your backup first.

A

Formulas at a glance

Every formula in this manual on one page, for quick reference.

CONCEPT	HOW IT'S CALCULATED
Price per unit	Purchase price ÷ Net content
With waste	Purchase price ÷ (Net content × (1 − waste %))
Line cost	Quantity × Price per unit
Production cost	Sum of lines (with PAX active, each quantity scaled and rounded up)
Unit cost	Production cost ÷ Yield
Price · 6 cost items	Unit cost + Sum of items ÷ Yield, rounded up to your currency's step
Price · Food Cost %	Unit cost ÷ Target %, rounded up to your currency's step
Price with commission	Price without commission ÷ (1 − Commission %)
Fixed cost per dish	Monthly fixed costs ÷ Estimated dishes per month
Total sales	Final price × Yield
Contribution margin	(Total sales − Production cost) ÷ Total sales
Cost %	Production cost ÷ Total sales
Cost of use (sub-recipe)	Total cost ÷ Yield
Inventory status	Critical if stock ⩽ minimum · Low if stock ⩽ 2 × minimum
Inventory value	Sum of (Stock × Container price ÷ Container content)
Theoretical stock	Last count + Purchases received − Sales consumption
Price of a drink	Cost per serving ÷ Target pour cost
Cost per serving	Milliliters served × Price per milliliter (with waste)
Servings per container	Usable content ÷ Milliliters served

CONCEPT	HOW IT'S CALCULATED
Count by weight	Unopened + (Weight - Empty) ÷ (Full - Empty)
Suggested quantity	Larger of (2 × Minimum - Stock) and the Minimum
Order total	Sum of lines + Tax
Menu average price	Sum of active dishes ÷ Number of active dishes
COGS	Opening inventory + Purchases - Closing inventory

B

Frequently asked questions

The most common “this isn't doing what I expected” situations, with their cause and fix.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1. Help chat

IF THIS HAPPENS…	WHAT TO CHECK
A recipe's cost comes out huge or absurd.	Check the yield and each ingredient's unit. If you use sub-recipes, make sure the quantity is in grams or milliliters, not units.
I changed a price and my recipes didn't move.	Recalculation is immediate. Make sure the recipe uses exactly that ingredient and not a duplicate with a similar name.
I can't see a module (Inventory, Finance, Team…).	Your plan doesn't include it, or the account owner didn't give you access. The on-screen message tells you which.
I marked an order as “Received” and an item wasn't added.	The app tells you which products weren't added: they don't exist in Inventory. Add them in Inventory and record the purchase in Inventory → New Purchase.
I saved a recipe with PAX active by mistake.	Use “Restore original recipe” and save again.
I left the Recipe Sheet without saving.	Go back to the Recipe Sheet within 24 hours: your recipe comes back on its own.
My emails arrive in another language.	Change the language in Settings → Regional while signed in; the next emails will arrive in that language.
I don't want reminders.	Use the “Stop receiving these emails” link or uncheck the box in Settings → Notifications.

IF THIS HAPPENS…	WHAT TO CHECK
My drink comes out with a very high price.	Check that its classification is a “Bar” one: that way the price uses pour cost instead of a dish's 6 cost items.
I didn’t get the confirmation email.	Check spam and tap “Resend the email” on the sign-up screen or when you log in. If it still doesn’t arrive, write to us from Contact.

Help chat

On every screen of the app, bottom right (above the bottom bar on a phone), there is the **help** button. It never opens by itself or interrupts you: it only shows a number when you have an unread reply.

1. **Pick the topic** of your question: Recipe Sheet, Ingredients, Inventory, Menus, Purchase orders, Sales and reports, Plans and billing, Account and team, Something isn’t working, An idea or Something else.
2. **Type your question.** As you type, the assistant shows the parts of this manual that answer it; tap them to read, or download the full manual as a PDF.
3. **If that’s not enough, send it to the team.** You can attach up to 3 files (3 MB in total): photos, PDF, Excel, CSV or text (the same formats the app accepts when importing).
4. **Wait for your turn.** We reply in order of arrival: the chat tells you how many people are ahead of you, or that you’re next.
5. **Get the reply** in the chat and by email, in your language. The email's button opens the chat so you can continue your case, even if you left the app. If you write again, you stay in the same conversation; once it’s solved, tap “It’s solved”.

Send a ticket. The second tab of the help panel works like “Suggestions and reports”: pick the type (bug report, suggestion, complaint or your experience), write your message and, if you want, attach a screenshot. When you send it you see your ticket number, and we reply by email.

You can also write to us from **Suggestions and reports**, at the bottom of Settings. We read every message.